NATIONAL PEACE AND RECONCILIATION COMMISSION

ANNUAL REPORT

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7th Floor First Mutual Building
99 Jason Moyo Avenue
Harare
Zimbabwe

Email: info@nprc.org.zw
Tel: +263 242 792 676-9
+263 242 791 757
Website: www.nprc.org.zw
@NPRCZim
@NPRCZim

A Peaceful Zimbabwe For All Generations





Peace begins with me; Peace begins with you; Peace begins with all of us

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LIST OF ACRONYMS

AMP	Adversely Mentioned Person
AU	African Union
BEAM	Basic Education Assistance Module
BUSE	Bindura University of Science Education
CCC	Citizens Coalition for Change
CEDAW	Convention on the Elimination of Discrimination Against Women
CEWER	Conflict Early Warning and Early Response
CHIL	Complaints Handling, Investigations and Legal Services
CPNR	Conflict Prevention and Non-Recurrence
CRGBV	Conflict Related Gender Based Violence
CSOs	Civil society Organizations
CSU	Counselling Services Unit
CZI	Confederation of Zimbabwe Industries
DRU	Dispute Resolution Unit
ERP	Enterprise Resource Plans
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
GBV	Gender Based Violence
HRR	Healing, Reconciliation and Rehabilitation
IDP	International Day of Peace
KII	Key Informant Interview
KMS	Knowledge Management Systems
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation
NAP	National Action Plan
NCIC	National Cohesion and Integration Commission
NDS	National Development Strategy
NPRC	National Peace and Reconciliation Commission
PCIA	Peace Conflict Impact Assessment
PMU	Procurement Management Unit
POLAD	Political Actors Dialogue
PPC	Provincial Peace Committee
PPDPA	Public Procurement and Disposal of Public Assets (Act)
PRAZ	Procurement Regulatory Authority of Zimbabwe
PWD	People With Disabilities
RECS	Regional Economic Communities
REPSI	Regional Psychological Support Initiative
RFQ	Requests for Quotations
RKM	Research and Knowledge Management
SADC	Southern African Development Community
SCORE	Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index
SI	Statutory Instrument
SOPs	Standard Operating Procedures
ToR	Terms of Reference
UN	United Nations
UNDP	United Nations Development Program

UNSCR	United Nations Security Council Resolution
UN Women	United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women
WPS	Women Peace and Security
YPS	Youth Peace and Security
ZANU-PF	Zimbabwe African National Union-Patriotic Front
ZEC	Zimbabwe Electoral Commission
ZGC	Zimbabwe Gender Commission
ZHRC	Zimbabwe Human Rights Commission
ZNCC	Zimbabwe National Chamber of Commerce
ZPCS	Zimbabwe Prisons and Correctional Services
ZRP	Zimbabwe Republic Police
ZIMSTATS	Zimbabwe National Statistical Agency
ZITF	Zimbabwe International Trade Fair

FOREWORD BY THE CHAIRPERSON



It gives me great pleasure to report on the achievements of the National Peace and Reconciliation Commission in the year 2022. I would like to extend profound gratitude to the Government of Zimbabwe through the Office of the President and Cabinet, the Office of the Minister of Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs, the various Government Ministries, Departments and Agencies, Independent Commissions, the Parliament of Zimbabwe and Development Partners for the integrated support to the Commission throughout the year.

The year began with a focus on peace education in preparation for the by-elections which were held in March 2022. The Commission was out in the ten Provinces ensuring that the message of peaceful conduct before, during and after elections reached far and wide. A research into the issues that unite Zimbabweans on the one hand but divide them on the other, was conducted during the year. The research is aptly named Social Cohesion and Reconciliation (SCORE). The findings from the research will allow the Commission to develop programs that enhance unity in the nation and mitigate the effects of conflict, polarization, intolerance and hate speech.

The year was not devoid of challenges. In spite of the challenges, the Commission remained devoted to the work of conflict prevention, healing and reconciliation. The Commission's key result area is measured through the National Development Strategy (NDS1) outcome of ***'Enhanced Social Cohesion'*** whose outputs include resolving conflicts, strengthening infrastructures for peace, setting up mechanisms to detect and respond early to conflicts, supporting victims of conflict through healing, reconciliation, rehabilitation and other victim and diversity centred approaches. The Commission is alive to the fact that many of its results depend on the extent to which the public knows about our work and engages with us from every corner of our nation. It is thus my greatest desire that in the coming year, the Commission increases its visibility and works smarter to take the message of peace to all corners of Zimbabwe.

Conflict is inevitable in any society; and despite all efforts made in peacebuilding, conflicts will always arise. It takes the efforts of all Zimbabweans to heed the messages of peace, unity, love, tolerance and reconciliation that are spread in our political, social, religious, spiritual, traditional, institutional and local spheres so that we harness the positives that our unique differences present. I therefore implore all of us to remain united for peaceful elections in 2023 and beyond. An upper middle-income society by 2030 is better achieved when we harness our developmental targets as a unified and cohesive collective. A peaceful Zimbabwe for all generations is possible.



Khotso ea qala le 'na; khotso ea qala le uena; Khotso ea qala le rona kaofela

Justice S.M. Nare (Rtd) (**CHAIRPERSON)**

NATIONAL PEACE AND RECONCILIATION COMMISSION

10 February 2023

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The year 2022 had opportunities for the Commission to spread its presence and improve its visibility around the country. With the restrictions on COVID-19 relaxed, the Commission realigned its strategy with a view to increase the expanse and coverage of its work in the country. The Commission's outcomes and outputs targets are outlined in the National Development Strategy 1 and are consistent with the Government of Zimbabwe's Integrated Results Based Management thrust for an improved and harmonized Whole-of-Government Performance Framework.

Targeting the national performance outcome of enhanced social cohesion, the Commission maintained strategic engagements with a variety of stakeholders, not least of which include the Responsible Ministry of Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs, Parliament of Zimbabwe, security institutions, Ministers of State and Secretaries for Provincial Affairs and Devolution, heads of key government departments at provincial level, the Chiefs Council of Zimbabwe, civil society organizations, Chapter 12 Independent Commissions, churches, youth organizations, women's organizations and local authorities. The engagements, while focused on addressing conflicts, also served as platforms to allow for exchange of ideas and information as well as improve collaborative efforts towards building a peaceful and united Zimbabwe.

The Commission undertook a learning visit to the Museum of African Liberation essentially to appreciate the true narrative of Africa's history and liberation. Following was a two-phase provincial peace education outreach programme which saw all provinces covered by a team of both Commission Members, staff and Provincial Peace Committee members in preparation for the by-elections which were held in March 2022. The Commission extracted lessons learnt from this peace education program to finalize its Elections Strategy, providing the electoral conflict prevention roadmap used in 2022 and to be strengthened in 2023 as part of its efforts to create an environment conducive for the conduct of peaceful and non-violent elections.

The Commission received and was able to attend to complaints from around the country ranging from land disputes, political violence, human wildlife conflicts, chieftainship and jurisdictional wrangles, community-investor conflicts, among others. Having targeted a response rate of 70% to the conflicts received, the Commission investigated and concluded 73% of the complaints. The Commission was unable to deal with all conflicts received as well as to expeditiously clear the complaints backlog because of funding challenges for investigations and follow-through support to victims of conflicts. However, having established effective referral pathways, some complaints were referred to other relevant state and non-state bodies thus guaranteeing assistance to victims who required support services that the Commission could not offer or had no mandate to address. To ensure that Zimbabweans had knowledge about the Commission's complaints handling and management platforms; awareness, sensitization and consensus building engagements were conducted with stakeholders at national, provincial and district levels.

Provincial Peace Committees and policy providing Thematic Committees continued to be the peace building architecture the Commission worked with in the year. The Commission's focus

was on strengthening the peace structures as evidenced by the sustained relations with the existing ten Provincial Peace Committees. Additional peace infrastructures include the Parliamentary Peace Champions (drawing membership from the Portfolio Committee on Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs and the Thematic Committee on Peace and Security), as well as the already existing District and Ward Peace Committees coordinated by non-state actors. These have been useful platforms used by the Commission to share ideas, feedback and receive information and generate lobbying and advocacy points on how to create and institutionalize peacebuilding in Zimbabwe. The Commission also worked with the Political Actors Dialogue Platform (POLAD) with whom synergies on mutually reinforcing functions of uniting the nation were established. Internally also, the Dispute Resolution Unit, established in terms of the NPRC Regulations, SI 90 of 2018 had interfaces meant to explore avenues of establishing a national network of mediators and conciliators. These efforts were complemented through a capacity building and peer-to-peer networking capacitation and exchange learning opportunity which Africa University supported.

The Commission worked on several programs targeted at the prevention of, and early response to conflicts. Some of these programs included the finalisation of a technical web-based Conflict Early Warning, Early Response (CEWER) system to enable the Commission to receive; in real time, and activate; as soon as is practical, responders to potential conflict risks and actual conflicts. Other preventive programs conducted include meetings and trainings of peace actors, generating preventive messages and commemorating the International Day of Peace (IDP), a day set aside for global citizens to cherish the values of peace and non-violence. The IDP commemorations were held in the Midlands Province. The commemorations were preceded by a 30-day serialization of the calls made by the Head of State and Government, His Excellency Dr E.D. Mnangagwa at several public forums that he addressed, calling on Zimbabweans to unite, shun violence, work together and cherish the values of dialogue.

A research into the issues that unite or divide Zimbabweans was conducted during the year. The research, named Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index (SCORE) was carried out in the ten provinces and conducted by a team of Consultants and enumerators identified and contracted by the Commission. The Zimbabwe National Statistics Agency (ZIMSTATS) provided the maps for the enumeration areas. The findings from this research were being finalised by year end and will form the basis for the development of a localised Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index as espoused in the National Development Strategy (NDS1).

The Commission reached out to youths from diverse backgrounds and organisations including but not limited to community youth actors, young women's organisations, youth with disabilities, and youth in political parties. This culminated in rallying momentum for Zimbabwe to expedite the development of the Youth, Peace and Security National Action Plan in line with the United Nations Security Council Resolution 2250. Also prioritised was awareness raising on gender-sensitive and inclusive peacebuilding programs. The Commission contributed to raising awareness on Resolution 1325 on Women, Peace and Security among stakeholders and communities through sensitization campaigns on the Resolution. Working together with the Ministries of Women Affairs, Community, Small and Medium Enterprise Development and Defence and War Veterans Affairs, UN Women and Parliament; national consultations targeted

at the members of the Commission's peace infrastructures generated input towards the development of the National Action Plan on Women Peace and Security.

The NPRC commemorated 16 Days of Activism Against Gender-Based Violence as a campaign platform to call for an end to Conflict-related GBV through activities held at both the NPRC Offices and in Caledonia, Mashonaland East as well as at the Great Zimbabwe University. Other reflections done included discourse with organizations representing men and women on how both can partner in advancing the cause for eradication of gender-based violence. At institutional level, the Commission held gender-based violence elimination programs. The Commission set up departmental gender desks to strengthen gender sensitive program implementation.

Mental health, alcohol and drug abuse have become a challenge in Zimbabwe's society, threatening to dilute efforts towards peace, as conflicts and violence are prominent among societies with high proliferation of drug users. The Commission partnered with a number of organizations and institutions, including the Zimbabwe Prisons and Correctional Services, in responding to this societal vice, which has led to the general degeneration of social support systems. The use of peer to peer support systems was proffered as one of the solutions to supporting young people affected by alcohol, drug and substance abuse. From community healing programs, drug abuse and suicide prevention programs implemented, the Commission noted the need for Government to prioritize the establishment of drug rehabilitation centres.

The visibility of the Commission improved in 2022, with the Commission's programs highlighted on various print and electronic media platforms. There are ongoing efforts to strengthen the visibility of the Commission based on the lesson learnt that multi-media is a powerful tool for disseminating the message of peace and raising the NPRC's profile. In line with Section 11 of the NPRC Regulations, the thrust in 2023 is to ensure that the Zimbabwean public is aware of the services that the Commission offers and can access them when they require.

Despite the efforts made to deliver on the outcomes and outputs for the year 2022, challenges continued to abound. The common thread across departments was the inadequacy of resources, poor internet connectivity, inflationary pressures affecting budgets, high human resource attrition as staff sought better opportunities or felt insecure because of the finite tenure of the Commission. At a programmatic level, the high levels of polarization in the country continued to affect efforts to galvanise efforts to build national cohesion.

Some of the recommendations advanced in this report relate to human and wildlife conflicts, traditional leadership appointment and jurisdictional disputes, political parties' conflicts and disputes over communal land and mining rights. The NPRC continues to appreciate the State and Non-State actors who complemented its efforts to bring about peace, social cohesion and reconciliation in Zimbabwe.

Luumuno lutalika andime; luumuno lutalika anduwe; luumuno lutalika andiswe toonse!

National Peace And Reconciliation Commission

Commissioners



Chairperson
Retired Justice S .M. Nare



Vice Chairperson
Rev. Dr C. Moyo



Commissioner
Dr G. Chekenyere



Commissioner
Mrs L. Chigwedere



Commissioner
Dr D. Dube



Commissioner
Adv. Obert C. Gutu



Commissioner
Mrs N. Gwere



Commissioner
Dr T. Rukuni



Commissioner
Dr J.Shambare

Executive Secretary



Executive Secretary
Mrs S. Zembe

General Managers



General Manager
CPMRT
Joseph Mashingaidze



General Manager
HRR
Cynthia Mawema



General Manager
VSGD
Egnes Nhengo



General Manager
CHIL
Tichafanana Sithole



General Manager
RKM
Donald Chirunga



General Manager
Finance
Brain Mangoro



General Manager
HR and Admin
Simbarashe Tongayi

National Peace & Reconciliation Commission

Managers



Manager
Audit
Matirasa Banda



Manager
Finance
Itayi Bangidza



Manager
Procurement
Ruth Jojo



Manager
CPMRT
Joseph T. Kauzani



Regional
Cordination
Manager
Jesca Majaha



Manager
ICT
John Paul Moyo



Manager
CHIL
Hlonipani Mpofu



Manager
Media &
Communication
Mercy Mtombeni



Manager
M&E
Mavis Mugaviri



Manager
VSGD
Caroline Munhuweyi



Manager
Legal
Marilyn Mutshina



Regional Coordination
Manager
Southern Region
Mathew Svodziwa



Manager
HR & Admin
Linah Zhakata

National Peace & Reconciliation Commission

Officers



OFFICERS
HR & ADMIN



OFFICERS
FINANCE



OFFICERS
CHIL



OFFICERS
VSGD



OFFICERS
RKM



OFFICERS
CPMRT

National Peace & Reconciliation Commission

Officers



OFFICERS
HRR



OFFICERS
SOUTHERN REGION



OFFICERS
EASTERN REGION



OFFICERS
NORTHERN REGION



OFFICERS
CENTRAL REGION

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

The National Peace and Reconciliation Commission (NPRC) is one of the five Independent Commissions established in terms of Section 251 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe Amendment (No. 20) Act of 2013. The work of the Commission is informed by Sections 233 and 252 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe, Section 3(2) of the National Peace and Reconciliation Act [Chapter 10:32], the provisions in the National Development Strategy 1, the NPRC 2021-2025 Strategic Plan; and is primarily aimed at fostering national unity, social cohesion, healing and reconciliation. The Commission is required in line with Sections 253 and 323 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe as well as Section 16 of the NPRC Act to present a report to Parliament, through the responsible Minister (Minister of Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs), outlining the pertinent peace and reconciliation issues that should be brought before the attention of Parliament and describing fully its operations and activities.

The NPRC is a mechanism for resolving the burden of past conflicts and building national and subnational capacities that guarantee a future of peace and reconciliation. As Zimbabwe undergoes critical socio-economic transitions that seek to transform the country towards sustainable development and improvement of people's lives, the Commission worked through its various departments in building values of tolerance and peaceful co-existence that enable sustainable and inclusive development. In conducting its work, the Commission ensured that women, men, children, youths, persons with disabilities, the faith community, the elderly, traditional authorities and other demographic groups actively take part in the consummation of national unity, peace and reconciliation. This was done to celebrate the country's rich and diverse traditions and cultures which form the base for entrenching our cherished values. Through peace outreach programmes and community-led conflict transformation and management programmes, local peace capacities have been established across the country. Efforts towards national visioning were also initiated at different levels of society, providing platforms for convergence and dialogue on key issues of national importance.

This report thus outlines the NPRC's work and what was achieved in 2022. Having had a full staff complement by the end of 2021 with four Regional Offices set up, this helped to increase the expanse of NPRC work countrywide.

1.2 NPRC Performance Targets for 2022

The Commission set its 2022 targets in compliance with the Government of Zimbabwe's Results Based Management thrust for an improved and harmonized whole-of-government performance framework. The performance targets were informed by this Theory of Change:

> *If the National Peace and Reconciliation Commission (NPRC) shepherds the country to deal with its past by initiating inclusive, gendered, knowledge-based and victim-centred healing processes; and facilitates the enhancement of national and sub-national policy frameworks and capacities for the management and transformation of conflict, thereby strengthening the peace infrastructures; then the country will be set on the path of sustainable development in a peaceful, united and reconciled nation.*

The NPRC's work fits within the **Governance National Priority Area** and contributes to the National Key Result Area **of National Unity, Peace and Reconciliation**, whose National Outcome is **Enhanced Social Cohesion**. The main outcome for the Commission is to achieve, **'Improved victim centred, inclusive and gender responsive community unity, healing and reconciliation**' and the targeted outputs in 2022 were:

a) Conflicts resolved
b) Legislative and policy frameworks for peace recommended
c) Truth telling and truth-seeking programs conducted
d) Infrastructures for peace building, including Conflict Early Warning Early Response (CEWER) system established
e) Assistance rendered to persons affected by conflicts
f) Historical conflict narratives and conflict risk models defined and documented

The ensuing sections shall cover the work done by the NPRC, captured under the following sections as prescribed in Section 16(1)-(6) of the NPRC Act:

a) Strategic engagements of the Commission;
b) Programs of the Commission in 2022;
c) Strategies for gender mainstreaming;
d) Challenges and lessons learnt;
e) Recommendations for the promotion of peace;
f) Financial Statements and Audit reports

2.0 NPRC STRATEGIC ENGAGEMENTS

2.1 Overview of NPRC Strategic Engagements

Peacebuilding work aims to resolve conflicts and injustice and to transform the cultural and structural conditions that generate deadly or destructive conflict. The process of engagement includes conflict prevention, conflict management, resolution, or transformation; and post-conflict reconciliation or trauma healing before, during, and after any given case of conflict and violence. As such, peacebuilding is a multidisciplinary cross-sector approach that seeks to establish and sustain relationships among people locally and globally; thus, engendering sustainable peace. Strategic peacebuilding activities address the root or potential causes of conflict, create a societal expectation for peaceful conflict resolution, and stabilize the society politically and socio-economically. The methods included in peacebuilding vary depending on the situation and the agent of peacebuilding. Successful peacebuilding activities create an environment supportive of self-sustaining, durable peace; reconcile disputing parties, prevent conflict from recurring; integrate civil society; create rule of law mechanisms; and address underlying structural and societal issues.

To attain its purpose, the Commission adopted '*strategic interactions'* as a critical methodology for successful implementation of its programs and operations, bearing in mind that the peacebuilding ecosystem is made up of various actors, both state and non-state. Strategic engagements in peacebuilding work, particularly in the work of the NPRC, allow talking to various actors and individuals with influence to resolve conflicts. Engaging those actors who are involved in a potentially conflictual situation or conflict dynamic environment helps to understand their positions, interests and thrust well ahead of intervention programs or activities.

2.2 Objectives of Strategic Engagements

Community engagement is at the heart of successful peacebuilding and sustaining peace efforts. In order to promote meaningful inclusion through broader partnerships there is need for strengthened and systematized engagement with several stakeholders. These include Government, the church, other faith groups, Parliament, civil society, including women and youth groups and local communities at large. Reflecting on the NPRC`s engagement with these actors; there are a range of forms this took. Collaboration were done through building capacity, sharing good practices, producing practical tools, fostering a conducive environment for robust engagement in analysis, planning, programming and monitoring and evaluation. In this regard, the NPRC has worked with different stakeholders to develop consensual community engagements on peacebuilding and sustaining peace through innovative, inclusive and consultative processes which sought to achieve the following objectives:

a) Support NPRC field presence and community engagement strategies on peacebuilding and sustaining peace;
b) Provide operational guidance on how to more effectively engage with actors at the local level in peacebuilding and sustaining peace.

In 2022, the NPRC carried out several engagements and met with the following stakeholders: Ministry of Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs, Parliament of Zimbabwe, security institutions, Ministers of State for Provincial Affairs and Devolution and heads of key government departments at provincial level, President of the Chiefs Council of Zimbabwe, Civil Society Organizations, Chapter 12 Independent Commissions, churches, youth organizations, women's organizations, institutions of higher learning and local authorities. Some of the engagements, though not directly dealing with any conflicts, served as platforms to allow exchange of ideas and information as well as improve collaborative efforts towards building a peaceful and united Zimbabwe.

2.3 Engagements During the Social Cohesion and Reconciliation (SCORE) Index Survey

The Social Cohesion and Reconciliation (SCORE) survey sought to improve the effectiveness of peacebuilding efforts based on evidence, and was designed to address the deficits in informing sustainable processes of conflict transformation. The backbone of SCORE is founded upon participatory research, where multi-level stakeholder consultations, focus groups and key informant interviews are conducted. These inform the calibration of the SCORE questionnaire, which draws from the extensive SCORE library of measurement instruments and indicators. In this regard, the NPRC conducted stakeholder consultations and engagements in all 10 provinces from March, 2022 to September, 2022. During this process, various stakeholder groups including Ministers of State, Secretaries for Provincial Affairs and Devolution, traditional leaders, the Zimbabwe National Statistical Agency, Parliament and Senate, security institutions, war veterans, women, youth, people with disabilities and other community leaders were engaged either as key informants or strategic support experts to the consultancy.

2.4 Engagements for Conflict Prevention and Guarantee of Non-Recurrence

A two-phase Provincial Peace Education outreach programmes were held in all ten provinces of Zimbabwe where the Commission interfaced with the officers commanding the Zimbabwe Republic Police (ZRP), Provincial and District Development Coordinators as well as Provincial and District Elections Officers of the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) and other electoral stakeholders in the targeted areas. The process of engagement was to receive buy-in and technical support for the constituency-based voter peace education leading to the 26th March, 2022 by-elections.



Figure 2.1: The Vice Chairperson of the NPRC, Rev Dr C. Moyo addressing Mashonaland West Chiefs, Senior Security Officers and other provincial leaders during a voter peace education program

A Parliamentary and Senate Peace Champions meeting was held in Harare in September, 2022 as part of their oversight role and support for the implementation of the Commission's programmes, including lobbying for the adoption and approval of the legislative recommendations. Likewise, the Commission continuously engaged the government, security sector, line ministries other Independent Commissions, faith-based institutions, corporates and civil society to forge synergies in the areas of conflict prevention, management, resolution and transformation.

2.5 Engagements in Support of Complaints Handling and Investigations

Section 6(3)(b) of the NPRC Act requires the Commission to cooperate and collaborate with other existing institutions such as Provincial Ministers, Provincial Secretaries, National Security Institutions, Civil Society Organisations, Faith-Based Organisations and the Media, among others in executing its mandate. In the spirit of this provision, the Commission carried out strategic engagements across the breadth of the country in line with set investigations targets and the prevalence and density of conflict. Twenty-one strategic engagements were done in the country as informed by conflict patterns in provinces. The purpose of these engagements was to secure the cooperation and the buy in of the various stakeholders as they hold influence in most of the disputes or conflicts investigated.

2.6 Victim Support Gender and Diversity Strategic Engagements

The Government of Zimbabwe through the Ministries of Youth, Sport, Arts and Recreation and Women Affairs, Community, Small and Medium Enterprise Development embarked on the process of developing Zimbabwe's National Action Plan on Youth, Peace and Security and Women, Peace and Security in line with UN Resolutions 2250 and 1325 respectively. The processes were led by respective Ministries with support from national steering committees in which NPRC was a part of. A series of engagements were carried out to lobby and advocate for the development of Zimbabwe's National Action Plans and these culminated in provincial consultations, meetings with Parliament and Senate's Champions as will be explained in detail in this report.

2.7 Synopsis of Engagements

Table 2.1 Programs done and support provided by key stakeholders

Stakeholder	**Activity**	**Thrust**	**Response**
Ministry of Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs	Engagements led to the tabling of the Commission's report and recommendations as well as plans for their implementation in line with the NPRC Act	Provide a link between Government, Parliament and the Commission	The Ministry provided policy guidance in line with its role as the lead agency on the NDS 1 Governance National Priorities.
Parliament of Zimbabwe	There were meetings with the Portfolio Committee on Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs and the Thematic Committee on Peace and Security	Parliament and Senate's roles are to provide oversight to all arms of state and government, including Independent Commissions	Valuable bilateral engagements were held between the Speaker of Parliament and the Commission as well as with the relevant oversight Committees
President of the Chiefs Council	Engaged with the Chiefs Council in finding common ground on mutually reinforcing peace	The traditional leaders are the custodians of culture and traditions and are also responsible	There is an overlap in the roles of the two institutions; therefore, there is need for both to

	efforts and with local traditional leaders on solving disputes around the country as well as developing strategies for non-recurrence	for administering of communal land and resolving conflicts	explore complementary programs
Ministers of State, Secretaries for Provincial Affairs and Devolution, Heads of Government Departments and Security Institutions in Zimbabwe	Since much of the work of the Commission is done in Provinces, the NPRC engaged with the Ministers of State for Provincial Affairs and Devolution and other relevant heads of government departments mainly to facilitate the implementation of Commission programs	These institutions spearhead government programs and activities where some conflicts have been reported and are part of the necessary support system for the resolution of the same conflicts	There has been continuous collaboration and exchange of ideas with these offices.
Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) and Churches	Strengthening collaborative peace building efforts in communities	The majority of the churches and CSOs who were engaged have been in peace-building work for some time and interact with many stakeholders who are interested in promoting peace and unity	The Commission held successful meetings with Civil society organizations and faith-based institutions and received input and concerns about how to improve on peace building synergies.
Other Independent Commissions	Conducting joint programs and sharing strategies on how to work together to achieve on the	Deliver on the common mandate in Section 233 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe and working jointly to	The commitment to work together was demonstrated in joint initiatives which were carried out including

	collective and individual mandates	ensure that citizens receive a holistic service from Independent Commissions in Zimbabwe	invitations to meetings or programs as well as collaboration in some programs, for example, voter peace education programs conducted around the country.



Figure 2.2 Staff of the NPRC and Zimbabwe Electoral Commission join hands to conduct their peace and voter education programs in Mashonaland East

3.0 PROGRAMS OF THE COMMISSION IN 2022

3.1 COMPLAINTS HANDLING, INVESTIGATIONS AND LEGAL SERVICES

3.1.1 Mandate of the Thematic Committee

The Complaints Handling, Investigations and Legal Services' (CHIL) mandate is derived from Section 252(f) and 252(j) of the Constitution of Zimbabwe Amendment (No 20) Act, 2013 and Section 3(2)(a) of the NPRC Act as well as the general provisions of the NPRC Regulations, S.I 90/2018

3.1.2 CHIL Targets for 2022

For the year 2022, the Department had the following targets and actual achievements;

Table 3.1: 2022 CHIL Targets Versus Achievements

Activity	Target	Actual Performance
Complaints to be handled	2500	255
Strategic engagements/Consensus building activities	50	60
Awareness campaigns	30	51
Finalization of investigations	70%	73%
Designing of tools of the trade and SOPs	100%	100%

In the period under review, the Commission did not receive the anticipated 2 500 cases which had been projected based on 2021 total cases of 2 336. The Commission continuously invoked Section 25(4) of the NPRC Regulation S9 90 of 2018 which mandates it to investigate cases relevant to its mandate even though not reported to it. The received cases remained low pointing to the efficacy of strategic engagements and consensus building activities as well as awareness campaigns which were surpassed by 20% and 70% respectively as shown in Table 3.1 above. The Commission anticipated to finalize at least 70% of the cases received. 186 of the 255 cases received were finalised, a 73% achievement. Table 3.2 on Page 10 shows a summary of the 255 cases which were investigated.

3.1.3 Awareness Campaigns

Awareness campaigns were carried out throughout the country to conscientize communities on the investigations work of the Commission. A total of 51 awareness campaigns were conducted during the year. These campaigns were informed by conflict patterns in all provinces of the country.

Table 3.2 Summary of CHIL 2022 Investigations

Province	**Mat North**			**Bulawayo**			**Mat South**			**Midlands**			**Masvingo**			**Manicaland**			**Mash East**			**Mash Central**			**Mash West**			**Harare**			Total
Total No of Complaints	7			4			2			11			8			28			23			24			11			137			**255**
Gender of Complainants	M	F		M	F		M	F		M	F		M	F		M	F		M	F		M	F		M	F		M	F		**255**
	4	3		1	3		2	0		7	4		6	2		10	18		20	3		21	3		7	4		94	43		
Dominant Nature of Dispute	Land Dispute			Land Dispute			Political Violence			Land dispute			Destruction of Property			Political Victimization			Political victimization			Political Violence			Land Dispute			Stand Dispute			
Nature of AMPs	M	F	J	M	F	J	M	F	J	M	F	J	M	F	J	M	F	J	M	F	J	M	F	J	M	F	J	M	F	J	**89**
	4	2	1	2	1	1	1	0	1	7	0	2	1	0	1	12	0	17	4	1	4	4	1	4	5	3	3	2	0	5	

Key

M – Male F- Female J – Juristic Person AMPs – Adversely Mentioned Persons

In the table above, 255 cases were received with a case being opened for each complainant. In some instances, one case had more than one Adversely Mentioned Persons (AMP). Juristic persons were also responsible for some of the cases as shown in Table 3.2 above.



Figure 3.1: NPRC team in the Southern Region (seated) conducting investigations in Kamalala Village, Hwange, Matabeleland North

3.1.4 Strategic Engagements and Consensus Building Workshops

Section 6 (3)(b) of the NPRC Act requires the Commission to cooperate with other existing institutions including other Independent Commissions, civil society, faith-based organisations and the media. In the spirit of this provision, engagements and consensus building workshops were carried out across the breadth of the country as informed by the targets, prevalence and density of conflicts. Among the offices visited were Civil Society, government heads of departments and the church across Zimbabwe.

3.1.5 Designing of Tools of Trade and Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)

In 2022, the Commission envisaged to design tools of the trade and operationalize Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs). Tools of trade and SOPs were designed and developed and approved by the Commission. Among the tools of the trade designed were;

a) Investigations Manual
b) Complaints Intake Book

c) Clients Charter
d) Acknowledgment of Receipt
e) Rejection of Complaint
f) Subpoena

Attendant SOPs for investigations were also operationalized; for example; procedures for assessing and attending to complaints.

3.1.6 General Findings of the Investigations

Investigations by the Commission during the year revealed the following issues;

a) Land disputes are a major factor generating conflicts in most parts of the country;
b) Historical political disputes remain the cause of most conflicts;
c) Reported cases of alleged partisan distribution of government aid.

3.1.7 Legal Services

The legal matters which the Commission dealt with in 2022 are highlighted below:

3.1.7.1 Litigation

Three cases were instituted against the Commission, one by a private individual and two by a human rights organization. The first matter dealt with the alleged failure of the Commission to publish the 2021 Annual Report. The matter was withdrawn as the Commission had duly publicized its Annual Report by March 2022. The second matter sought to contest the appointment of one of the NPRC Commissioners, and the matter was dismissed because it lacked merit. The third matter raised queries and instances where the NPRC allegedly failed to act or perform its functions as laid out in the Constitution. Opposing court papers were drafted and submitted after which the Commission procured the services of external legal practitioners who then appeared on behalf of the NPRC. Two of the three civil matters have been concluded while one is still pending. It is the view of the Commission that the outstanding matter will be withdrawn because it lacks merit, and does not comply with the High Court Rules.

3.1.7.2 Review of Legal Documents

As a creature of statute, the Commission is expected to comply with the law in its operations. All internal legal documents are reviewed to ensure that they comply with and protect the

interests of the Commission. In the year, 2022 the Commission concluded various memorandums of agreements with institutions of academia and non-governmental institutions. These documents were reviewed and approved by the Commission. Other such legally binding documents include procurement and human resources contracts, and internal policies.

3.1.7.3 Legal Education

To ensure that the Commission work complies with the NPRC legal framework, the following internal legal training activities were conducted.

a) Induction of Staff

The Commission trained newly appointed members of the Secretariat on the legal framework of the NPRC. The induction focused on the functions and roles of the Commission as laid out in the Constitution, the NPRC Act and the S.I 90 of 2018 Regulations.

b) Dispute Resolution Unit Training

Section 252 (i) of the Constitution obligates the NPRC to conciliate and mediate disputes among communities, organisations, groups and individuals to promote social cohesion. S.I 90 of 2018 provides for the establishment of the Dispute Resolution Unit (DRU). In compliance with the legal provisions, the Commission established the DRU in 2020. However, in 2021 it underwent a change in composition of its members as newly appointed Commissioners joined the Commission. Training on the legal frame work governing the establishment, composition, function and roles of the Dispute Resolution Unit in terms of the S.I 90 of 2018 Regulations was conducted. The objective of the training was to ensure that members of the DRU appreciated the legal provisions governing the work of the Unit.

c) Training of Thematic Committees

The Research and Knowledge Management as well as Conflict Prevention and Non-Recurrence Thematic Committees were established to enhance the work of the Commission in research and knowledge systems as well as prevention of conflicts. The Committees were trained on the legal framework of the Commission namely, Constitution, NPRC Act, the Regulations S.I 90 of 2018, and NDS1.

3.1.7.4 Other Internal and External Collaborations

a) Complaints Handling and Investigations

Legal support was rendered to the Complaints Handling and Investigations teams as they embarked on engagements with key stakeholders in various districts within the country. The team engaged with gate keepers who are on the ground dealing with everyday experiences of communities who highlighted the various conflicts arising within their areas. Gaps in the law, policies and administrative measures and strategies were identified and are carried in this report.

b) The Zimbabwe Gender Commission (ZGC)

The Legal Services of the Commission took part in the ZGC Gender Forum in Bulawayo under the theme *'Gender and Economic Empowerment for Inclusive Economic Growth.'* The process of engagement identified the current challenges and opportunities for women in the economic sector. It also identified the underlying obstacles that limit the roles of women in key economic sectors and how this is interlinked to gender-based violence. The key driver of gender-based violence is the existing limited opportunities available to women to enhance their economic welfare and effective participation. It was recommended that to ensure economic development in line with the National Development Strategy 1, stakeholders must facilitate the opening of the economic space through gender sensitive programs that empower women, promote equal and effective participation to end gender-based violence and achieve social cohesion through economic emancipation.

c) Law Society Open Day 2022

The Commission participated in the Law Society Open Day which was held in Plumtree. The objective of exhibiting at the Open Day event was to allow members of the public in Plumtree to interact with the NPRC and other key stakeholders within the justice delivery sector. This increased the visibility of the NPRC and positively enhanced the delivery of justice to the needy and indigent without cost. The Commission also disseminated information on the Constitution and rights entrenched within the Declaration of Rights. This was an opportunity to conduct awareness campaigns as information on the mandate of the Commission, as embedded within the Constitution, NPRC Act and Regulations was explained to the general public who attended the event.



Figure 3.2: NPRC Legal Manager (seated left) joined by other NPRC Officers at the Law Society Open Day in Plumtree

3.2 CONFLICT PREVENTION AND NON-RECURRENCE

3.2.1 Mandate of the Thematic Committee

The work of the Commission on conflict prevention and non-recurrence was informed by the need to implement the following strategic programs and activities:

a) Establishing and conducting programs with infrastructures for peace;
b) Setting up and operationalising the Conflict Early Warning and Early Response (CEWER) system;
c) Conducting conflict prevention programs and implementing the elections conflict prevention strategy
d) Conducting dialogue and mediation programs

3.2.2 National and Sub-National Infrastructures for Peace

Section 252(d) of the Constitution of Zimbabwe provides for the development of national and subnational institutions and mechanisms for the management of conflict issues. The

Commission sustained relations with the existing 10 Provincial Peace Committees, Conflict Prevention and Non-Recurrence Thematic Committees, the Parliamentary Peace Champions Platform, as well as the already existing District and Ward Peace Committees coordinated by non-state actors.

3.2.2.1 Thematic Committees on Prevention and Non-Recurrence

The Commission had meetings with the two Thematic Committees from the Southern and Northern Regions which play an advisory role to the Commission. Hence, the two meetings held in Bulawayo and Harare were focused on updating the committees on the developments and achievements of the Commission and for the committees to share their insights on strengthening prevention and non-recurrence work.



Figure 3.3 Members of the Thematic Committee on Prevention and Non-Recurrence chaired by Commissioner Dr Rukuni (seated second from left) with the Vice Chairperson, Mrs Munodawafa (seated second from right)

Some of the suggestions the Committees proffered to the Commission include:

a) The need for the creation of a platform that ensures that NPRC's infrastructures for peace meet and plan regularly;

b) Proposals for the Commission to facilitate inter-political party and other multi-stakeholder dialogue meetings which in turn would ascertain and manage conflict risks.

c) The need to identify focal peacebuilding champions who intervene on the ground if any conflict issues arise;

d) Processes on conflict prevention should not be in silos but must address tangible challenges of concern (economic, social and political).

3.2.2.2 Provincial Peace Committees Peace Building Programs



Figure 3.4 Members of the Manicaland Provincial Peace Committee preparing to participate in by-elections observations in March 2022

The Commission made efforts for the increased involvement of Provincial Peace Committee (PPC) members in provincial programs particularly those that the Commission facilitated or was actively involved in this year. The Commission sought the involvement of the PPC members as part of its focus to engage communities and increase the visibility of its programs. Members of the Commission's peace infrastructures at the provincial and community levels were effectively mobilised during the Social Cohesion and Reconciliation survey, the Voter

Peace Education and elections observation programs, as well as consultations on the development of Women and Youth Peace and Security National Action Plan. Apart from the active involvement of the PPCs, the Commission, as the national infrastructure with the constitutional mandate to oversee peace, unity and reconciliation in Zimbabwe, worked with other organisations in the peace building ecosystem. These strategic engagements allowed NPRC to engage with District and Ward Peace Committees already established by other actors such as the civil society and faith-based organizations. Such strategic collaborations have increased the number of functional infrastructures for peace that the NPRC is working with or established at National and Sub-national levels.

3.2.2.3 Establishment and Capacitation of Local Peace Committees

The Commission aimed at increasing the capacity of infrastructures for peace to provide the required local solutions to conflict situations. Training and skills development became necessary to enhance high-impact programmes output. As such, four local organizations were assisted by the Commission to establish and capacitate Local Peace Committees and their members in Caledonia, Mutoko, Buhera, and Nkulumane. These structures received training and support from NPRC in areas such as dialogue and mediation, conflict prevention and management, gender and conflict as well as developing operational terms of references. These capacitation programs also helped the Commission to conduct a mapping exercise for local peace infrastructures for the purposes of further capacitation and strategic collaborations as they feed into the National Peace Infrastructures database.

3.2.2.4 Parliamentary Peace Champions Engagement

A review meeting held in Mutare in July 2020 between the Commission and the Parliamentary and Senate Oversight Committees recommended the identification of "... *Peace Champions from the two committees whom it will keep close contact with to advocate on its behalf"*. A successful interface was facilitated with the twelve Parliamentary Peace Champions drawn from the joint Thematic and Portfolio Committees on Peace and Security and Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs. The meeting was an opportunity for the Commission to:

a) Share with the Peace Champions the peace building programs of the Commission and receive insights on how the programs can be enhanced to the expectations of the Peace Champions;

b) Advocate for the adoption of the recommendations from the 2021 and other previous Annual Reports;
c) Lobbying for increased resource allocation and generation of ideas and strategies for resource mobilization for the Commission;
d) Share strategies on the promotion of unity and cohesion as the country moves towards 2023 harmonised elections;
e) Make considerations by the Legislature for an open-ended tenure for the Commission.

During the special engagement with the Peace Champions, the Portfolio Committee Chairperson, Honourable Mataranyika and Senator Chief Ngungumbane who was representing the Senators shared remarks on behalf of the Champions and gave the following feedback:

a) Acknowledgement of the Peace Champions' lobbying role for Peace building programs as it reinforces impactful programs;
b) Encouraging the Commission to aim at visiting and copying strategies from other Peace Commissions in other African Countries and beyond, if need be, the Commission should visit countries such as Kenya and Rwanda;
c) The need to find out and address the root causes of conflicts in the country as well as increase visibility particularly now that the country is preparing for the 2023 elections;
d) The Peace Champions assured the Commission that they would go back and review the Terms of References (ToRs) for Peace Champions and would come back for clarity if need be;
e) Assured the Commission of their support on issues of financing NPRC programmes as well as counter-productive investor-host communities' induced conflicts;
f) The Champions made a clarion call to the NPRC to regularly give feedback to the committees so that they remain abreast with what is happening within the Commission as well as to tap issues for lobbying and debating in Parliament.

Through the partnership with these Peace Champions, the Commission held programs to which the Peace Champions provided support and guidance, including lobbying for additional funding from the fiscus, commemoration of 16 Days of Activism Against Gender Based Violence and providing input for the development of Women and Youth Peace and Security National Action Plans.



Figure 3.5 Parliament and Senate Peace Champions led by Chairperson of Thematic Committee on Peace and Security, Sen Dr D. Parirenyatwa (seated right) and Chairperson of the Portfolio Committee on Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs Hon M. Mataranyika (seated third from left), Chief Ngungumbane (seated third from right) pose for a photo with the Chairperson of NPRC Justice (Rtd) S.M. Nare (seated centre), the Vice Chairperson, Rev Dr C. Moyo and Members of the NPRC

3.2.3 Conflict Early Warning and Early Response System (CEWER)

Over the past two years, the Commission has been working towards establishing a functional web-based Conflict Early Warning and Early Response (CEWER) system as provided for in Section 252(g) of the Constitution. This will assist the Commission to proactively detect and respond to conflicts. In 2022, the architectural design of the segmented CEWER system was completed; with indicators focusing on the Political, Security, Environmental, Socio-Economic and Socio-Cultural factors. This process received technical and financial support from local and regional stakeholders, enabling the NPRC to set up the physical infrastructure of the system whose customization process has been finalised. The fully customised system is expected to support the systematic data collection, analysis and/or formulation of recommendations, including risk assessment and information sharing on areas of conflict in order to make decisions about effective response strategies.

A total of 32 individuals were capacitated on the CEWER system including 5 Members of the Commission, 7 from the Secretariat and 20 Conflict Prevention and Non-Recurrence Thematic Committee members supported the internal development and feedback on the system. An address of students at Solusi University was also done to help them understand the Commission's early warning system and how as academia and youths, they could contribute to enriching it.



Figure 3.6 Commissioner Dr Rukuni (second from left front row) and Commissioner Gwere (centre, front row with senior leadership and students of Solusi University after addressing them on peace and conflict issues, including early warning

The follow through initiative is to create a network of CEWER monitors and responders who will be adequately trained and capacitated to detect, monitor, report and respond to potential conflicts before they escalate into violence. One hundred such actors drawn mainly from the provincial peace architectures are expected to receive training and the pre-requisite tools of trade that will enable them to carry out their duties at community level, feeding into the system on a daily basis. These actors will play a pivotal role at community level so that the system can effectively function and provide the much-needed early warnings, responses and referral pathways.

3.2.4 Conflict Prevention Programs

The Commission's conflict prevention programs are employed to pre-empt and subsequently neutralise potential causes of violent conflict. In implementing conflict prevention programs as provided for in Section 252 (h) of the Constitution of Zimbabwe, the Commission conducted a number of activities in the year.

3.2.4.1 Implementation of the Election Conflict Prevention Strategy



Figure 3.7 An NPRC Officer addresses members of the Anglican Church Mother's Union during a voter peace education program in Harare

The Commission approved Elections Conflict Prevention Strategy was developed primarily to help create an environment conducive for the conduct of peaceful elections and to minimise conflicts and violence pre, during and post elections. In implementing this strategy, the Commission executed various activities which included stakeholder engagement meetings, voter peace education campaigns and elections observations. Teams were deployed in all the ten provinces to educate the electorate on the importance of peaceful elections towards the 26th March by-elections. A two-phased voter peace education campaign took place with the teams led by Commissioners for the respective provinces spearheading the community level

education campaigns which were also supported by the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission personnel in other Provinces. The first phase directly reached out to 8,458 whilst the second phase engaged 16,453 prospective voters. The Commission's digital media platforms also complemented the voter peace education messages.

There was positive feedback from the various communities as most people appreciated the Commission for being visible at local level and deciding to leave no-one and no place behind in its conflict prevention programmes. The public however, noted that the Commission still needs to do more in terms of awareness raising and peace education should not be limited to elections but it should be conducted frequently. There were challenges in terms of resources to reach further distances in the provinces something which members of the public also complained about as they advised that many conflicts are left unattended in the hard-to-reach areas. Subsequent to the voter peace education programs, the Commission deployed a total of 89 peace observers drawn from NPRC staff and accredited members of the provincial peace committees. The observation went well and the elections were peaceful and non-violent.



Figure 3.8 NPRC voter peace educators in Matabeleland South, led by GM Mawema (second from left) meet with the Minister of State for Provincial Affairs and Devolution Hon Ncube (centre)

3.2.4.2 Public Awareness and Media Engagements

The Commission compiled conflict preventative peace messages for its social media platforms as part of the election conflict prevention tools. The Commission ran a peace campaign through sharing of the peace messages on all platforms reminding people of the importance of maintaining peaceful relations before during and after elections. Moreover, the Commission engaged local gospel musicians in the composition of peace medley songs which will be aired on local radio and television stations. Zimbabwe Female Gospel Artists Association led by Ms Mharidzo Hetisani together with prominent gospel artist, Baba Mechanic Manyeruke and other local musicians have since composed and recorded peace songs that will be used to spread the gospel of peace, unity and cohesion in Zimbabwe despite our various ethnic, religious and political differences.

3.2.4.3 International Day of Peace Commemorations



Figure 3.9 One of His Excellency, the President's peace messages shared as part of the countdown to the International Day of Peace

The International Day of Peace is a flagship event of the NPRC as it joins the rest of the world in commemorating the World Peace Day. On that note, the Commission managed to compile the President of Zimbabwe's peace and unity messages since the coming in of the Second Republic. A newspaper article on the Second Republic's peace efforts and press statement was published in The Herald on the 15th and 21st of September, 2022 respectively as part of the International Day of Peace commemorations. There was a thirty-day countdown process where the His Excellency, the President's peace messages were published on the Commission's social media pages, in recognition of the Second Republic and the Head of State and Republic's strong and appealing call for Zimbabweans across the divide to unite and shun violence.

The official address came from the Minister of State for Provincial Affairs and Devolution, Hon L.D. Mavima who thanked NPRC for choosing the Midlands Province to be the host of the 2022 national commemoration which ran under the theme: 'Promote inclusivity. Build Peace'. He also implored all Zimbabweans to remain peaceful, united and focused as what unites us as Zimbabweans is much stronger than what separates us.



Figure 3.10 Guest of Honour at the IDP commemorations, Hon Minister L.D. Mavima releases peace doves as an exhortation for peace and unity in Zimbabwe

At Regional Offices, the Commission also conducted White Ribbon activities while engaging members of the public on and raising awareness on IDP, an activity which reached out to 500 participants in the Southern Region, 234 in the Eastern region and 187 in Mashonaland West. This strengthened the decentralisation of the commemorations and improved visibility and effective presence at provincial level. Other partners who also conducted IDP commemorations, notably Africa University, the Zimbabwe Christian Alliance and 4-H Zimbabwe had representatives of the NPRC deployed to support and where requested, offer messages of solidarity.

3.2.5 Dialogue and Mediation

The Constitution of Zimbabwe, Section 252(i); provides that the Commission shall *'conciliate and mediate disputes among communities, organizations, groups and individuals.'* The Commission's strategy was to strengthen capacities for dialogue and mediation as a way of promoting continuous and constructive engagement among citizens at national level and subnational levels. Some of the programs covered by the Commission include:

3.2.5.1 Dispute Resolution and Mediation

In line with the provisions in Part VII Section 53-64 of the NPRC Regulations, SI 90 of 2018, the Commission set up a Dispute Resolution Unit which coordinates efforts to mediate and conciliate disputes. The Commission has continued with the efforts of sustaining the Dispute Resolution Unit and thus reconstituted the structure as provided for in the NPRC Regulations. Two meetings were conducted during the year to set the tone of the work of the Unit as guided by the NPRC Regulations and the NPRC Act. A process was also undertaken to identify a panel of twenty-five mediators and conciliators who will work together with the Commission to support the provision of mediation services when need arises.

In order to strengthen dispute resolution and mediation capacities, five of the Commission's secretariat representatives attended a peer-to-peer learning program which brought together other experts previously trained on insider mediation to share experiences and emerging issues in the field. As a follow up to this, one of the Commission's Managers was selected to attend another regional peer-to-peer session in Kenya to strengthen work on supporting insider mediation for sustainable transformation of conflicts. The local and regional discourses

covered conflict transformation, dialogue, analysis of conflicts in Zimbabwe, diversity and complementarity in networking of mediators.



Figure 3.11: The Commission's Eastern Regional Manager, Ms Nyasha Kuture (extreme right), joins other mediators in a regional peer-to-peer exchange program in Kenya

3.2.5.2 Meetings with Political Actors Dialogue Platform (POLAD)



Figure 3.12 The Commission meets with members of POLAD in Bulawayo

The Commission has had ongoing engagements with the Political Leaders Dialogue (POLAD) platform. Two meetings were held, with the initial meeting having been conducted in Bulawayo in April 2022 themed *"Uniting Zimbabweans for resolving violent conflicts of the past and institutionalizing approaches for preventing their recurrence in the future*". This was followed by a meeting of co-conveners held in Kariba which developed the future pathways of programming between the Independent Commissions and the POLAD. The Commission also worked on the preparatory planning and documentation which in 2023 will see political actors coming together to commit to peace and non-violence during elections through the signing of the electoral peace pledge.

3.3 HEALING, RECONCILIATION AND REHABILITATION PROGRAMS

3.3.1 Mandate of the Thematic Committee

The Healing, Reconciliation and Rehabilitation (HRR) Thematic Committee's role is to facilitate the fulfilment of the NPRC functions by providing opportunities for people affected by violence to share or narrate their experiences. From these experiences the Committee has developed appropriate healing and reconciliation activities and programmes. The work of this Committee relies on collaboration with other NPRC Thematic Committees and various stakeholders from Government, Church, Traditional leaders, Civil Society to name just a few. The collaboration is designed to strengthen already existing programmes and reach a wider spectrum of society. The major output indicator for the Thematic Committee is '*Assistance rendered to persons affected by conflicts*.'

The Commission realized the output through four major programs, namely;

a) Learning visits on Healing and Reconciliation
b) Awareness raising on Healing and Reconciliation and learning visits
c) Community Healing
d) Positive Policy and Legal Environment for Peace

3.3.2 Learning Visits on Healing and Reconciliation

A learning visit to the Museum of African Liberation was conducted with seven out of nine Commissioners participating. There was agreement for the Museum and the Commission to foster a partnership especially in healing. As such, it was agreed that a workplan be developed between the two institutions. At the end of the visit, the Museum donated one copy of the

"Africa Fact book," for use in the Commission's Resource centre. The version donated is one out of 50 copies signed by His Excellency the President of the Republic of Zimbabwe Comrade E.D. Mnangagwa. This publication will assist in coming up with correct narratives of Zimbabwe's liberation history thereby contributing towards the healing of wounds inflicted by some untruths that have been peddled about the country as well as augment the Commission's Resource Centre.



Figure 3.13: Donation of Africa Fact Book by CEO of the Institute of African Knowledge, Ambassador Kwame Muzawazi (Left) to the Commission represented by Commissioner Dr Shambare (second from left), Commissioner Chigwedere (second from right) and Commissioner Adv. Gutu (right)

3.3.3 Awareness Raising on Healing and Reconciliation and earning visits

The objectives of awareness raising on Healing and Reconciliation are;

a) To engage with stakeholders in healing and rehabilitation so as to share knowledge;
b) To explore ways and areas of collaborations with the stakeholders so as to strengthen partnerships;
c) To learn from the partners how they rehabilitate their clients and exchange information with a view to capacity building.

As part of capacity building and learning, collaborations were made with the following organisations and institutions; Tree of Life for psycho social support; Ingutsheni Hospital for mental health; Zimbabwe Prisons and Correctional Service for rehabilitation of former prisoners and Ruwa Rehabilitation Centre for rehabilitation programmes. From the interaction, the Commission's capacity and competence in effective management of victims requiring assistance has been enhanced.



Figure 3.14: The NPRC Southern Manager Mr M. Svodziwa (right) with staff at Ingutsheni Hospital

3.3.4 Community Healing

Community Healing involves creating environments of collective care, where wellbeing is prioritized. Since many social ills arise out of social disorder and traumatic events, the establishment of healthy community bonds can restore and rebuild the foundations of trust needed by an individual. Community healing includes community engagement to assist key stakeholders in applying evidence-based practices to addressing social ills as well as programs designed to allow individuals within communities to design interventions to improve community cohesion. The Commission undertook community healing for various groups including its staff.

3.3.4.1 Mental Health and Wellness for Commission Staff

In its broad statement, the HRR mandate provides that citizens of Zimbabwe have access to programs on healing at all levels, including the staff in the Commission. In light of this need,

the Commission launched a Mental Health and Wellness program for Commission staff. In designing this program, a needs assessment was done through a brief questionnaire which was shared with staff. The objective of the exercise was to provide a needs-based platform to improve Commission staff's health and wellness at the workplace. The needs assessment was conducted to also ascertain the level of staff knowledge around issues of mental health.

3.3.4.2 Debriefing of Staff Post Research Fieldwork

Realising the potential for secondary trauma on staff after engaging in the on the development of a national Social Cohesion Index (SCORE), the Commission planned a debriefing session for staff at the conclusion of the fieldwork. A variety of healing techniques were employed including group therapy during which staff shared their experiences and afforded peer to peer support. The feedback revealed that staff had to some extent experienced trauma without realising it. It became clear in the session that some of the behaviours they had exhibited post the fieldwork were as a result of trauma. The exercises, related to strengthening coping strategies and selfcare, are said to have helped in coping with the trauma experienced.



Figure 3.15: Commissioner Chigwedere (standing in second row, second from right), joins employees participating in a post-SCORE debriefing exercise

3.3.4.3 Mental Health and Wellness for the Community

The Commission participated in a program on the Rehabilitation of Urban Slums held in Harare coordinated by Dialogue on Shelter Trust. The rehabilitation of urban slums is a global initiative to reclaim slums and develop them into habitable residential areas. This is in

recognition that urban local authorities do not have enough land to allocate to the growing population of urban dwellers, most of whom are moving from the rural areas in search of economic opportunities in cities and towns. A program of this nature provided the Commission an opportunity to contribute towards the solution to the rehabilitation of the homeless. Furthermore, the program sought to engage local authorities on regularizing the stay of illegal settlers who had, over the years, faced demolition of residential structures.

A community healing program was undertaken with the following organizations: Dialogue on Shelter for the Homeless and Zimbabwe Federation for the Homeless. The two institutions work with Informal Settlement Networks to reach out to grassroot communities for community healing initiatives and awareness raising as well as preaching the message of peace. Community leaders expressed the need for trauma healing and psychosocial support in informal settlements, because land related issues are core to the wellbeing of a society.



Figure 3.16: Commission's HRR staff with Community leaders in Dzivaresekwa, Harare

3.3.4.4 Trauma Healing

In partnership and collaboration with the Counselling Services Unit (CSU), the Commission provided psychosocial support to victims of trauma using a triangulation of methods of trauma healing. The victims included individuals who had experienced trauma within their

communities. The support to victims was mainly through workshops as well as one-on-one healing sessions whose main objective was to restore impaired capacity, improve integration of victims into the communities and mitigate fear and anxiety. To date the Commission has interacted with forty victims of trauma (30 women and 10 men). The partnership with CSU continues to grow from strength to strength and further collaboration has resulted in the development of a manual for use by health workers meant to assist in the health and trauma management of victims of conflict. The manual should be ready for validation, distribution and use in the first quarter of 2023.

3.3.4.5 Healing and Reconciliation of Broken Families in Epworth, Harare

This program was held under the theme '*Healing broken families through the Church'*. The key objectives of the program were to raise awareness on the NPRC mandate; to provide holistic support to affected communities through the provision of psycho-social support and counselling, receive complaints and provide mediation to strengthen community led programs and improve the healing and reconciliation mechanisms. The stakeholders engaged with included; the Office of the Member of the National Assembly for Epworth, Councillors from all the seven (7) wards in Epworth and church leaders from different denominations.



Figure 3.17: NPRC Commissioners, members of NPRC secretariat, Vice Chairperson of the NPRC Harare Provincial Peace Committee, Pastors and Epworth community members taking part in a community healing and reconciliation program

An exercise on appreciative inquiry was undertaken which involved the participants articulating the positive things found in Epworth as well as the causes of broken families. The yielded the following:

- ✓ affordable rentals
- ✓ affordable basic commodities
- ✓ good roads with no potholes
- ✓ District Court under construction
- ✓ cheap transport,
- ✓ infrastructural development
- ✓ tourist attraction (balancing rocks)

On the other hand, participants noted concerns about the following as causes of conflict:

- ✓ drug abuse
- ✓ gender-based violence
- ✓ early childhood marriages
- ✓ poor representation by elected officials
- ✓ double allocation of premises
- ✓ prostitution
- ✓ unemployment
- ✓ breakdown of families

The resultant need was healing and reconciliation of broken families. A total of 110 participants (26 males, 84 females) drawn from the under 18 (2), 19-35 (32), 34-64 (58) and above 65 (18) age groups participated in the sessions. Of these, three were people with disabilities. Ward 6 had the highest number of participants (71) and Ward 3 had the least (3).



Figure 3.18: Apostle Violet of Vision Protectors giving closing remarks and declaring an end to the challenges bedevilling the community in Epworth

Table 3.3: Profile of Participants Disaggregated by Sex, Age, Disability and Location

Indicator	Indicator category	Number	Total
Sex	Male	26	
	Female	84	110
Age	Less than 18 years	2	
	19 to 35 years	32	
	36 to 64 years	58	
	Over 65 years	18	110
Disability Category	Visually impaired	1	
	Wheel chaired	1	
	Assistive devices (Crutches)	1	3
Location	Ward 1	6	
	Ward 2	12	
	Ward 3	2	
	Ward 4	8	
	Ward 5	3	
	Ward 6	71	
	Ward 7	8	110

A continuing partnership with the Church had the Commission participating in a Thanks-Giving and Prayer for Zimbabwe Program with about 60 people in attendance. The event was organized by Vision Protectors International in collaboration with a number of Churches in Msasa Park in Harare where emphasis was put on praying for the nation's leadership for continued wisdom and for a violence free nation.

3.3.4.6 Program on Addictions, Alcohol, Drug and Substance Abuse

The program on addictions, alcohol, drug and substance abuse held in Guruve District of Mashonaland Central, sought to contribute towards healing and reconciling of communities affected by drug and substance abuse. The Commission worked with the Zimbabwe Prisons and Correctional Services (ZPCS) whose mandate converges with that of the NPRC in the area of rehabilitation. The three-day program sought to raise awareness on the dangers of drugs, alcohol and substance abuse after recent trends showed that Guruve District is

struggling with drug addiction, alcohol and substance abuse mostly amongst the young generations.

Participants were drawn from the following communities: business, church fraternity, government departments notably, the Ministry of Youth, Sport, Arts and Recreation, the ZRP, ZPCS, President's Office, community-based organisations, prison inmates, schools and community members. A total of 148 people (66 females and 82 males) attended the 3-day workshop as shown in Table 3.4 below:

Table 3.4: Participants Attendance at Workshop on Addiction and Substance Abuse

Sex	**Age**				**Total**
	>18yrs	**19-35yrs**	**36-64**	**65+**	
Females	2	40	23	1	**66**
Males	1	49	32	0	**82**
Total	**3**	**89**	**55**	**1**	**148**



Figure 3.19: The Community in Guruve follows proceedings of the workshop

Testimonies by former drug users were given with encouragement that it is possible to recover from drug and substance abuse. The most effective testimonies were given by the inmates themselves, who were part of the participants. In addition, and as part of their contribution towards the elimination of drugs, inmates joined the ZPCS and NPRC teams as they visited schools in Guruve District, essentially for school going learners to learn first-hand the reality of what happens to offenders of drug and substance abuse. The majority of the inmates incarcerated for drug related crimes, are aged less than 30 years.

Table 3.5: Number of Learners Reached with the Message

Day	Name of School	Total Number Reached
1	St Francis and St Clare	1400
	Kondo High	1400
2	Muzika primary	900
	Kondo Primary	2000
3	St Philips Mangwenya	760
Total		6460



Figure 3.20: (Left) Learners listen in to a presentation by the NPRC General Manager Mr T Sithole while (Right) Inmate giving out prizes to children at Muzika Primary School in Guruve after sharing on the dangers of drug abuse

Learners from schools received prizes after answering buzz questions, quizzes and reciting poems on the dangers of drug and substance abuse. The day was made lively by the sharing of testimonies from incarcerated inmates. In addition, as part of ensuring peer to peer support on the prevention of alcohol, drug and substance abuse in schools, the Commission involved leaders in the school architecture, namely members of the Junior Parliament representing Guruve.



Figure 3.21: From left: Junior Parliamentarian Hon. Kudakwashe, Vice Chaplin, former Junior Parliamentarian Comely Matope, Vice Chaplin Florence Manema and Jubilee Chiangwa all from St Francis & St Clare High School sharing their experiences on Schools visits by NPRC and Partners



Figure 3.22: Commissioner Dr J. Shambare, Commissioner C. Gezi, ZPCS Mashonaland Central Province and Commissioner L. Chigwedere following workshop proceedings

On the whole, the community bemoaned the society's reluctance to accept former prison inmates back into the society upon release from prison due to the stigma suffered by families of former inmates. This was corroborated by the ZPCS who narrated an experience where they struggled to return a former prison inmate to their family as the family stated that they had ostracized the individual.

3.3.4.7 Suicide Prevention and Intervention Mechanisms

As a follow up to the interaction with ZPCS in Guruve, a workshop on Suicide Prevention and Intervention Mechanisms was conducted in Bindura, Mashonaland Central. As with the workshop on drug and substance abuse, the objective was to sensitize members of the public on the prevalence of suicides and how they can provide support in their communities. The presenters at this workshop included representatives from Freda Rebecca Gold Mine, Nyaradzo Funeral Services, the Church, Traditional leaders, the ZRP, Bindura University of Science Education (BUSE), local Psychologists other Medical Practitioners and NPRC. The Commission interacted with 92 participants at the workshop.



Figure 3.23: Sgt Major S. Chikasha, ZRP Provincial Spokesperson presents global and local statistics on suicide prevalence

Statistics shared by the ZRP Provincial Spokesperson showed that according to the World Health Organisation:

- ✓ About 800 people worldwide take their own lives each year;
- ✓ In Africa, Zimbabwe is ranked number 5 in the prevalence of suicides;

- ✓ The majority of suicide cases reported being male;
- ✓ There are early warning signs to victims intending to commit suicide;
- ✓ 80% of victims signal their intention to commit suicide;
- ✓ In some instances, there have been reports of recurring suicides within families;
- ✓ The most affected groups are those in the 13 to 30-year range.

In Mashonaland Central alone, 35 cases were reported in 2021 and by the third quarter, the year 2022 had seen an increase to 53 cases. The statistics indicate urgency for interventions on suicide in the province.

Deliberations with the participants centred on, **"What can be done to reduce cases of suicides in Mashonaland Central?**" A summary of responses included the following;

a) Bring back Ubuntu so that people are there for each other;
b) Opinion leaders should realise the impact of their actions to the society;
c) Stigma on suicides must be removed;
d) Control of the social media content (both print and electronic);
e) Education and counseling awareness campaigns;
f) Youth must be taught to work hard to earn a living;
g) Need to intensify the fight against drug, alcohol and substance abuse.

3.3.4.8 Community Healing and Psychosocial Support

The Commission arranged joint teams comprising the Healing, Reconciliation and Rehabilitation officers as well as complaints handling and investigations experts on a program following up on previously reported complaints. The team covered the provinces of Mashonaland Central, Mashonaland East and Mashonaland West. The aim was to support victims from whom reports had been received for investigations. The victims were provided with psycho-social support to improve functioning in their day to day life after their experiences of trauma. It was noted that there is need to constantly provide mediation and reconciliation programs among conflicting parties. In Mashonaland West communities lacked information and understanding of procedures on how to benefit from social services provided by the government such as Presidential farming inputs and Basic Education Assistance

Module (BEAM) which often resulted in conflicts reported to the Commission. A total of 30 victims (22 males and 8 females) were assisted with psychosocial support.

3.3.4.9 Healing of Victims of Road Traffic Accidents

The Commission conducted a community healing session at Tynwald High School, following the tragic accident which occurred in Nyanga, Manicaland and claimed the lives of six leaners and one teacher. The objective of the visit was to console and provide psycho-social support to the Headmaster, staff and the students. In partnership with the Church, the Commission was joined by Apostle Violet Magombo of the Vision Protectors International who prayed for the school and help them deal with the traumatic event.

3.3.5 Positive Policy and Legal Environment for Peace

Part of the mandate of the HRR is "to recommend legislation to ensure that assistance, including documentation, is rendered to persons affected by conflicts, pandemics or other circumstances." A visit to the Ruwa Rehabilitation Centre in Harare revealed potential areas for policy and legal recommendations. Due to the name "Rehabilitation Centre", the surrounding community has been making calls for the Centre to accommodate and assist victims of drug and substance abuse. Their cry comes because most of the available centres for drug rehabilitation are privately owned and out of reach for the majority of Zimbabweans.

There is need for increased number of State sponsored drug Rehabilitation Centres in the country. With changes in the policy and legal framework, the Commission sees the centre which has ideal infrastructure accommodate a drug and substance abuse rehabilitation program. It is therefore recommended that provision be made for appropriate facilities for drug rehabilitation centres, mental health and wellness centres close to communities. With appropriate change in policy and legal framework, Ruwa Rehabilitation Centre could be converted into a one stop shop to provide all the relevant healing and rehabilitation services required within Harare and the country at large.

3.4 RESEARCH AND KNOWLEDGE MANAGEMENT PROGRAMS

3.4.1 Mandate of the Thematic Committee

The Research and Knowledge Management Thematic Committee, chaired and deputised by Members of the Commission, comprises membership from the ten State Universities and organisations with expertise in research and documentation such as Research Council of Zimbabwe, National Archives of Zimbabwe and other Civil Society Organisations. The overall objective is to advise the NPRC in the generation of knowledge through evidence-based research and collaboration with experts and the academic community. Under Research the sub-program outcome was to improve Social Cohesion and understanding of conflict dynamics and the following were the sub-program outputs

a) Development of a Social Cohesion and Reconciliation (SCORE) index
b) Capacity building on research methodologies conducted
c) Peace education curriculum lobbied

Under Knowledge Management Systems (KMS) the sub-program outcome was to improve access to knowledge by all stakeholders and the following were the sub-program outputs

a) Knowledge Management Systems (KMS) developed (data collection, storage, analysis, documentation, dissemination and archiving systems);

b) Peace Resource Centre (PRC) established;

c) Academic roundtables and knowledge sharing platforms conducted.

3.4.2 Legal and Policy Footing

Section 252(h) of the Constitution of Zimbabwe Amendment (No 20) Act 2013 empowers the Commission to do anything incidental to the prevention of conflict and promotion of peace. Section 3(2)(b) of the NPRC Act further empowers the Commission to research the nature, scope, extent, and causes of conflicts and the intervening strategies for those disputes and conflicts. Further, the National Development Strategy 1 (NDS) empowers the Commission to promote and enhance social cohesion and reconciliation in Zimbabwe as a contribution to the attainment of Zimbabwe's Vision to become an empowered upper-middle-income economy by 2030.

3.4.3 Developing a Shared Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index for Zimbabwe

One of the signature programs for the Commission in 2022 was spearheading the development of a domesticated Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index. The Commission organised the development of a shared Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index which is a process of measuring peace by assessing the extent to which society is in peaceful co-existence and harmony with its members. Although the Commission had a number of research-related sub-programme outputs, priority was given to the development of the SCORE index.

The NPRC conducted engagements with different provincial stakeholders prior to the commencement of the SCORE fieldwork. The Speaker of Parliament, Ministry of Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs, the Office of the President and Cabinet were among the key stakeholders who were consulted during the SCORE process. These stakeholder engagements provided the Commission with the targeted districts and wards in each province in which SCORE fieldwork was conducted. The Consultants together with the NPRC engaged in an exercise meant to clean and sharpen the data collection tool in line with NDS1 outputs and targets. It is against this backdrop that the Commission was given the greenlight to commence the SCORE fieldwork.

3.4.3.1 Background to SCORE

Since the attainment of independence in 1980, Zimbabwe is still grappling in developing a shared national vision embraced by all regardless of political affiliation or background. Political polarisation and 'fracturing' of the society impede the process of nation building in Zimbabwe thus directly affecting sustainable peace and development. It is against this backdrop that NPRC worked on developing a shared Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index for Zimbabwe which will be responsive and sensitive to the Zimbabwean context.

3.4.3.2 Data Collection

Data was collected in all the 10 provinces of the country. The Commission adopted a conflict sensitive approach in the carrying out of this survey. This meant that at all times the Commission remained sensitive to the needs and expectations of the stakeholders and communities as teams conducted the survey.

3.4.3.3 Pilot study

A pilot study was carried out in Zimunya, Mutare District in Manicaland with the view of:

a) Testing and validating the tool
b) Testing the gadgets and adjust where necessary
c) Addressing issues of translation to the questionnaire
d) Testing the enumerators flexibility with the tool against time



Figure 3.24 The SCORE field team led by Dr S. Mungure (centre, in blue shirt) preparing for the pilot survey in Zimunya, Mutare District

Data was collected using three methodologies as listed below:

a) Key Informant Interviews

The SCORE index analysis is premised at the provincial level. Thus, the data collected in each district represents the unique and representative issues of a given province. Key Informants Interviews were done at the provincial and national level with leadership: and were targeted at:

i. Office of the President and Cabinet
ii. Responsible Ministry (Ministry of Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs)
iii. Speaker of Parliament
iv. State Organs and Agencies
v. Independent and Executive Commissions
vi. Chiefs' Council
vii. War Veterans
viii. Leading Business Organizations (CZI/ZNCC)

ix. Civil Society Organizations
x. Women's Organizations
xi. Youth Organisations
xii. Political Parties
xiii. People with Disabilities

b) Focus Group Discussions (FGD)

The focus group discussions were done at a district level. Three FGDs were done in each district to make them six for the two selected districts per province. These three FGDs were categorized as follows; women organizations, youth organizations and a mixed group.

c) **Questionnaires**

Questionnaires were distributed in two districts in each province. The enumeration areas were drawn from selected wards within the selected districts. Each enumeration area had 25 households which were covered.

3.4.3.4 Sample Design

The table below shows the districts in which Key Informant Interviews (KII), Focus Group Discussions (FGD) and Questionnaire distribution was conducted:

Table 3.6: Administration of KIIs, FGDs and Questionnaires

Province	**KII**	**FGD/Questionnaire**
Harare	Harare	Highfields; Mbare Kuwadzana; Epworth
Mashonaland Central	Bindura	Mazowe; Mbire
Mashonaland East	Marondera Town	Marondera; Wedza
Midlands	Gweru	Chirumhanzu; Mberengwa
Mashonaland West	Chinhoyi	Hurungwe; Sanyati
Bulawayo	Bulawayo	Sizinda; Mahatshula; Nkulumane

Province	KII	FGD/Questionnaire
Matabeleland North	Lupane Town	Binga; Lupane
Matabeleland South	Gwanda	Beitbridge; Matobo
Manicaland	Mutare	Mutasa; Chipinge
Masvingo	Masvingo	Bikita; Chiredzi



Figure 3.25: NPRC Members, Staff and Consultants preparing for SCORE fieldwork in the Southern Region: the Chairperson, Rtd Justice Nare (seated third from left) flanked by Commissioner Gwere (second from left), Commissioner Dr Dube (centre) and the Executive Secretary, Mrs Zembe (seated, third from right)

The community-based research assisted in unearthing the conflict dynamics per province which in turn will assist the country in proffering solutions that are province based in order to improve harmony and co-existence in our communities and overall; enhance the social cohesion of our nation. Above all, this assisted the Commission to remain NDS1 compliant as this is one of the Commission's key performance indicators.

3.5 VICTIM SUPPORT, GENDER AND DIVERSITY PROGRAMS

3.5.1 Mandate of the Thematic Committee

Gender-inclusive and victim-centred peacebuilding ensures the achievement of sustainable peace outcomes. Section 9 of the NPRC Act mandates the Commission to mainstream gender imperatives into every aspect of its work and to put in place and implement mechanisms for supporting victims of Conflict-Related Gender-Based Violence (CRGBV). In pursuit of this, the following was done in 2022:

a) Strengthening youth participation in peace building;
b) Awareness raising, lobbying and advocacy for gender-sensitive and inclusive peacebuilding as well as campaigns against Conflict-Related GBV.
c) Rendering assistance to victims of conflicts.
d) Participation at national and regional strategic meetings on Victim Support, Gender and Diversity.

3.5.2 Strengthening Youth Participation in Peace Building

NPRC Act, Section 9 (b) mandates the Commission to develop strategies to encourage the participation of women, girls and other marginalised groups in the work of the Commission. The NPRC Gender and Inclusion Policy further obliges the Commission to engage and ensure the meaningful participation of women, men, boys, girls and youths in peacebuilding processes. In 2022, several initiatives were put in place to strengthen youth participation in peace-building processes and these include:

3.5.2.1 Youth Consultative and Engagement Meetings

The Commission reached out to 565 (288 female and 277 male) youth from diverse backgrounds including but not limited to community youth actors, young women's organisations, youth with disabilities and youth in political parties through the following:

a) National youth consultative and engagement meeting held on the 8th of April 2022;
b) Bulawayo -Regional Youth consultative and engagement meeting held on the 31st of October 2022;

c) Harare-Regional Youth consultative and engagement meeting held on the 4th of November 2022.



Figure 3.26: Commissioner Gwere (on screen) and participants of the National Youth Consultative and Engagement meeting held in April 2022.

Key messages relayed to the youth and or for consideration by the youth included the call for them to:

a) Use technology and social media positively to spread peace messages instead of hate speech and cyberbullying;
b) Identify and implement key actions that will raise youth voices, agency and leadership in electoral conflict prevention. This can be done through taking advantage of national programmes that enhance youth participation in conflict prevention and peacebuilding programmes such as the NPRC National Conflict Early Warning and Early Response system (CEWER);
c) Desist from participating in acts of violence, violent extremism, and other activities that fuel violence and hinder the achievement of sustainable peace;

3.5.2.2 Youths' Recommendations to Advance their Participation in Peacebuilding

a) Entrench the youth and peace issues in the education system and conduct awareness-raising initiatives to build understanding and a culture of peace amongst

	the youth while strengthening youth's ability to engage constructively in civic structures and political processes
b)	Increase inclusive representation of youth in peacebuilding decision-making at all levels (community, sub-national and national mechanisms).
c)	Domesticate the United Nations Security Council Resolution (UNSCR 2250) and the African Union (AU) Continental Framework on Youth, Peace and Security (YPS), and other normative frameworks on YPS through the development of a National Action Plan (NAP) on Youth, Peace and Security.
d)	Conduct socio-cultural activities that enhance cohesion and tolerance amongst the youth such as sports and arts and promote young people's participation in conflict prevention initiatives, particularly as the nation gravitates towards the 2023 harmonised elections.

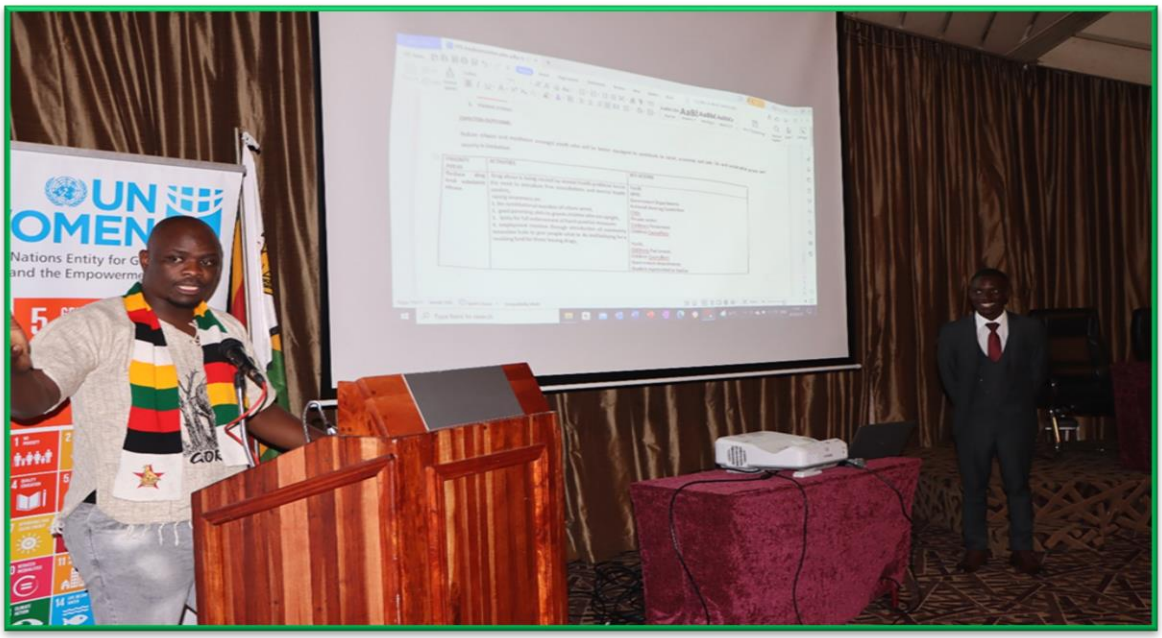


Figure 3.27: Enhancing cohesion and tolerance among the youth in Political Parties-ZANU PF Youth Member (left) and CCC Youth Member (right) sharing a platform during a Youth Peace engagement meeting in Harare

3.5.2.3 Adoption of UN Resolution on Youth, Peace and Security (YPS)

The Commission noted the importance of the framework in guiding youth-inclusive peacebuilding initiatives and Chapter 12 Commissions' objectives and mandate to support accountability to the implementation of Regional and International Instruments that promote

gender-inclusive peacebuilding. In light of this, the NPRC engaged the Ministry of Youth, Sport, Arts and Recreation and the National Youth Council on the need to develop the United Nations Security Council Resolution 2250 on Youth, Peace and Security National Action Plan. The key outcome of the NPRC lobbying and advocacy engagements saw a commitment by the Government of Zimbabwe, through the Ministry of Youth, Sport, Arts and Recreation to develop a National Action Plan on YPS. The development of the Youth, Peace and Security National Action Plan is envisioned to solidify the Government's commitment to put youth at the centre of peace and security processes. This will facilitate collaboration among stakeholders on youth, peace and security issues while strengthening young people's full and equal participation in peace and security processes.



Figure 3.28: Youth who participated at the National Youth engagement meeting consultative meeting in Harare on the 8th of April 2022

The NPRC's lobbying and advocacy efforts were further catalysed by outcomes of the High-level Inter-Ministerial Conference on YPS held in Harare from in July 2022, which highlighted the role of Regional Economic Communities (RECS), Regional Mechanisms and Governments in promoting the YPS Agenda in the Southern African Countries. Subsequently, and attesting to this commitment, the Ministry of Youth, Sport, Arts and Recreation, supported by the NPRC conducted a workshop to develop the Draft Zimbabwe National Action Plan on Youth, Peace and Security in Kadoma in October 2022. The Drafting Workshop produced a Zero Draft National Action Plan on YPS for Zimbabwe. The Draft will be used as a framework for consultation and engagement with young people in all Provinces to facilitate the gathering

of inputs from sub-national level youth representatives and other key stakeholders on the issues, interventions and strategies to be incorporated into the Youth Peace and Security NAP.

3.5.3 Campaigns Against Conflict-Related GBV

Information dissemination and awareness raising on gender-sensitive and inclusive peacebuilding facilitates the application and implementation of gender-responsive peacebuilding approaches by members of the public and stakeholders. In the year under review, the Commission conducted several awareness-raising programmes to enhance the implementation of gender-sensitive and inclusive peacebuilding programmes and conducted campaigns against GBV at different levels and platforms through media and physical activities. The highlights include the following:

3.5.3.1 Adoption of UN Resolution on Women, Peace and Security (WPS)

Noting the limited knowledge and awareness on Resolution 1325 on Women, Peace and Security among stakeholders and communities, the NPRC conducted several sensitization and awareness campaigns on the Resolution at different levels. Resolution 1325 is an important framework that supports and guides actions for gender-inclusive peacebuilding and the prevention of Conflict-Related GBV. The UNSCR 1325 acknowledges and addresses how women and girls are disproportionally impacted by conflicts and recognizes the critical role that women play in peacebuilding. Awareness campaigns on the United Nations Security Council Resolution 1325 on Women, Peace and Security were held as follows:

a) Provincial Meetings

Sensitisation and awareness-raising meetings on the UNSCR 1325 were conducted simultaneously in six provinces namely; Manicaland, Mashonaland East, Masvingo, Midlands, Matabeleland South and Bulawayo in June 2022. Through the provincial awareness meetings, the Commission reached 510 people (300 female and 210 males).

b) Meeting for Members of Parliament

A sensitisation and awareness-raising meeting for Members of Parliament was held.

The meeting brought together 55 Honourable Members (43 female and 12 male) representative of different Portfolio and Thematic Committees of Parliament.

c) Stakeholder Sensitization on UNSC Resolution 1325

A breakfast meeting for national stakeholders was held in November 2022. The meeting was themed *'Men as partners in supporting the implementation of Resolution 1325'* and brought together 53 people (29 female and 24 male) from different peace-building-related institutions.



Figure 3.29 Commissioner Chigwedere (kneeling) meets with Parliamentarians and Senators during consultations on implementation of UNSCR 1325

Key emerging issues from UNSCR 1325 sensitisation and awareness raising meetings include the need to:

a) Sustain conversations on UNSCR 1325, including cascading knowledge on the Resolution to other stakeholders in hard-to-reach communities in local languages;

b) Implement sustainable resourcing mechanisms to ensure full and effective implementation of Resolution 1325 and facilitate institutionalisation of UNSCR 1325 principles in line with respective organisational mandates to enhance domestication of the resolution while Government pursues finalisation of the WPS NAP.



Figure 3.30: Vice Chairperson of the NPRC, Commissioner Rev. Dr. C. Moyo (Right) giving welcome remarks and Mrs. S. Zembe, Executive Secretary of the NPRC moderating discussions during the UNSCR 1325 Stakeholder awareness breakfast meeting in November 2022.

Further to the above and building on its 2021 work, in 2022, the NPRC continued to strengthen its lobbying and advocacy efforts for the development of the United Nations Security Council Resolution (UNSCR) 1325 National Action Plan. In view of this, the NPRC supported the following processes:

a) Induction workshop for Technical Committee and key stakeholders on the development of the NAP held in February 2022. The meeting capacitated key stakeholders with relevant information on Resolution 1325, National Action Plans and on NAP development processes;
b) Drafting clinic for the National Action Plan in March 2022. The Drafting Clinic produced a Draft National Action Plan based on the four pillars; prevention, participation, protection, relief and recovery; highlighting key activities, outputs, indicators, baselines, means of verification, time frames and the budget for implementing the Action Plan.

3.5.4 Commemoration of International Days on Gender

Through the media and conduct of physical activities, the Commission brought awareness on the need for gender-inclusive peacebuilding and ending conflict-related GBV while simultaneously extending recommendations to relevant stakeholders through conducting and commemorating the following International Days and programmes ;

a) International Women's Day

The commemorations brought prominence on the role of women in peacebuilding particularly, peacebuilding and decision-making.

b) International Youth Day

The Commemorations noted the need to establish sustainable and vibrant Youth- Peace Programmes.

c) International Rural Women's Day

The commemorations celebrated and profiled the role of rural women in fostering community social cohesion.

d) International Day of the Girl Child

The commemorations celebrated and profiled the role of the girl child in fostering peace.

e) Awareness Raising through Field Work Processes

Awareness on the need for gender-inclusive peacebuilding and ending conflict-related GBV was also done through interaction with community members and community leaders during fieldwork.

f) Awareness Raising through Outdoor Media

Billboards with key messages on gender-inclusive peacebuilding and ending conflict-related GBV were instituted in Masvingo, Mashonaland Central and West Provinces.

g) Commemorations of 16 Days of Activism Against Gender-Based Violence

The NPRC commemorated the 16 Days of Activism Against Gender-Based Violence as a campaign platform to call **for an end to Conflict-related GBV** through physical activities held at NPRC national and regional offices and in Caledonia, Mashonaland East, targeted at Caledonia Community Members.

h) Staff Sensitisation and Awareness on GBV

While raising awareness on GBV issues, the meeting noted the need to implement mechanisms to strengthen GBV prevention and response amongst staff:



Figure 3.31 (Above Left), Chairperson of NPRC, Rtd Justice S.M. Nare, giving welcome remarks; (Right) Commissioner Gwere giving background to 16 Days of Activism Against GBV. Beneath, participants during the staff sensitisation and awareness raising on Gender-Based Violence

3.5.4.1 Mechanisms to Strengthen GBV Prevention and Response Among Staff

a) Institute and implement a zero-tolerance policy on bullying, sexual harassment, and gender-based violence between and amongst staff members through a vibrant institutional Sexual Harassment Policy;
b) Establish mechanisms to support victims of gender-based violence at the workplace, including instituting a gender-sensitive and inclusive mechanism for complaints handling and investigation of sexual harassment cases;

c) Create a safe work environment that encourages sexual harassment reporting and provides victims with the necessary psychological, social and legal support and protection during investigations;

d) Conduct targeted male GBV engagement meetings while encouraging reporting of GBV by men;

i) Caledonia Community Commemorations

The commemoration was held in Caledonia in December 2022 and attended by a total of 418 community members (293 females and 125 males) as a victim support follow-up process to reports on conflicts brought to the Commission by the Caledonia community. Whilst sharing the mandate of the NPRC in addressing conflict-related GBV, the community programme amplified the negative impact of CRGBV on individuals and society at large and proffered recommendations to enhance peace and social cohesion in the community.



Figure 3.32: Community members and stakeholders following proceedings of the 16 Days of Activism Against GBV Commemorations at Caledonia, Mashonaland East Province.

The key messages relayed by speakers to the Caledonia community and for consideration by all communities in strengthening community social cohesion include:

a) Celebrating the diversity of political, religious and individual differences including respecting and responding to the needs and concerns of different gender groups (youth, women, men, boys, girls, and the elderly) while recognising that disability issues cut across all gender groups;
b) Meaningfully participating and working with all relevant stakeholders to prevent and end all forms of violence and conflict-related GBV while closely collaborating with law enforcement agents and other stakeholders in providing protection and response mechanisms to victims of conflict-related GBV particularly women, girls and other vulnerable groups;
c) Promoting a climate of peace and tolerance in all electoral processes, safeguarding the safety and security of women and girls, noting that GBV often increases during the electoral periods.

The following emerging issues drawn from the interaction with the Caledonia community will help to shape future NPRC and other stakeholders' community peace-building and conflict prevention programmes.

3.5.4.2 Community Lessons Drawn from Engagements in Caledonia

a) There is need to intensify community advocacy and awareness campaigns on the extent and consequences of conflict-related gender-based violence through utilising community communication platforms;
b) There is need to employ an inclusive approach where all gender groups are engaged and involved in fighting conflict-related gender-based violence including through developing targeted interventions and mechanisms to enhance the participation of vulnerable groups such as women, youths and persons with disabilities in peacebuilding programmes;
c) There is need to bring more awareness on the complaints handling and investigations mandate of the NPRC and other Chapter 12 Commissions to strengthen the response and protection of victims of conflict-related gender-based violence in communities;
d) There is need to train various community stakeholders on peacebuilding issues and the importance of safeguarding women's rights in conflict situations.

3.5.5 Rendering Assistance to Victims Affected by Conflicts

Section 9 of the NPRC Act mandates the Commission to put in place and implement mechanisms for supporting victims of conflict-related GBV. The Standard Procedures for Handling and Supporting Victims of Conflict-Related GBV further set out a procedural and guiding framework on how the Commission and its stakeholders can effectively provide support to victims of conflict-related GBV. Emphasis is made on the need to ensure gender-sensitive and inclusive complaints handling and investigations that consider the different lived experiences of men, women, boys, girls and youths as well as the psycho-social needs of victims during and after violent conflicts. It is because of this, that the Commission participated in several fieldwork activities to support victims of conflict-related gender-based violations. Other victims were further supported through the referral systems as provided in the Standard Procedures for Handling and Supporting Victims of Conflict-Related GBV.

In 2022, collectively, the Commission provided support to 7,984 victims through psycho-social support and referrals disaggregated as reflected in Table 3.7 below:

Table 3.7: Number of Victims Supported by the Commission and Areas Visited

Area and Dates	Violations Suffered by Victims	Female	Male	Total
16-23 May Manicaland Province -Nyanga	Land disputes Political violence	10	2	**12**
16 June Harare Province-Epworth	Gender-based violence Displacements Early marriages	89	31	**120**
12-14 July Mashonaland West Province Guruve	Drug and substance abuse Physical violence	4066	2733	**6799**
22 Aug – 3 Sept 2022 Mash East, West and Central	Loss of land Gender-based violence-sexual abuse of girls Physical violence	23	8	**31**

Area and Dates	Violations Suffered by Victims	Female	Male	Total
9 December 2022 Caledonia-Mashonaland East Province	Land disputes Political violence Gender-based violence Drug and substance abuse	293	125	**418**
Support to Walk-In Victims	Gender-based violence Land and housing disputes Conflicts and disputes in communities	310	60	**4**
Referrals and follow-up to registered victims		325	275	**600**
Grand Total		**4807**	**3177**	**7984**

Victim support field visits conducted illuminated best practices to be pursued by the NPRC in providing sustainable and comprehensive victim-centred services as follows:

a) Create safe spaces and opportunities for marginalised and excluded groups to voice their vulnerabilities and needs, transform themselves in the aftermath of conflict and develop confidence and capacity for effective engagement in peacebuilding;
b) Establish community-sustained structures for counselling and psycho-social support of victims;
c) Extend training on victim support to Provincial Peace Committees as they also handle victims of CRGBV in their respective areas;
d) Institutionalize wellness centres at NPRC offices which will serve victims as well as members of staff;
e) Undertake capacity building on victim support as a continuous process where refresher courses for all members of staff are periodically held.

3.5.6 Participation at Strategic Meetings on Victim Support, Gender and Diversity

Participation at National and Regional Strategic engagements and meetings on Victim Support, Gender and Diversity helps to inform policy formulation and programme development. In the year under review, the NPRC participated in three (3) Regional meetings

on victim support, gender and diversity. Further, the NPRC also participated in several National strategic meetings on Victim Support, Gender and Diversity as a way of pursuing partnerships and collaborations as well as sharing information on the need for gender-inclusive peacebuilding and ending conflict-related GBV. Participation of the NPRC at all levels included being part of the key speakers, discussants and panelists. The three (3) regional meetings attended by the NPRC mainly focused on the implementation of the Women, Peace and Security agenda in the region. These include:

a) Webinar on sharing of South-South and South-North experiences on the development of National Action Plans for UNSCR 1325 in February 2022;
b) SADC Regional Consultation meeting on the Women Peace and Security (WPS) Agenda, Johannesburg, South Africa in July 2022;
c) Eastern and Southern Africa Regional Workshop on Best Practises and Experience Sharing for Impactful National Action Plans on Women, Peace and Security, Dar es Salaam, Tanzania in September 2022.

3.5.6.1 Key Lessons from the Regional Meetings for Implementation by the NPRC

a) The need to create women networks on WPS and the identification of WPS Champions at all levels including at the community level so as to increase voices on the role and participation of women in peace and security matters;
b) Conduct WPS capacity building and awareness-raising programmes at all levels to support the implementation of the WPS Agenda;
c) Develop a database of women in peacebuilding leadership and decision-making to support data collection as an accountability mechanism for monitoring and tracking equal and balanced participation and representation of women and as a mechanism to provide a springboard for the creation of women in peacebuilding networks;
d) Document and profile women's positive narratives on peace geared towards enhancing women's participation in peace-building decision-making tables;

3.5.6.2 Lessons from Regional Meetings for Peace-Building Stakeholders

a) Foster strong coalitions, cross collaborations and involving multi-stakeholders in the development of the NAP including, but not limited to, Government Agencies, institutions responsible for peacebuilding, UN Agencies, CSOs, women, traditional,

and religious leaders, youth groups and private sector as a strategy to ensure that diverse views and interests are integrated into the NAP development process;

b) Establish working groups to monitor implementation, set strategic goals, evaluation of progress and conduct frequent consultations with stakeholders;

c) Ensure inclusive NAPs that incorporate the needs and interests of women's groups, particularly young women peacebuilders and young women affected by conflicts and violence), persons with disabilities and women from hard to reach communities;

d) Align and strengthen linkages of WPS NAPs with other relevant Agendas including the Youth, Peace and Security Agenda and the 2030 Agenda for sustainable development and its promise for gender-equal, inclusive and peaceful societies;

e) Include Monitoring and Evaluation Frameworks, with a focus on data collection and setting clear performance indicators for measuring and monitoring NAP progress as well as to support reporting to AU and Regional Economic Communities;

f) Mainstream the Women, Peace and Security agenda in the broader Government and institutional programmes and ensure that the WPS Agenda feeds into the implementation of National Development Strategy 1 and other Policies.

3.6 FINANCE, ADMINISTRATION, HUMAN RESOURCES PROGRAMS

3.6.1 FINANCE

3.6.1.1 Funding from Government of Zimbabwe

a. 2022 Budget

The Commission received a resource envelope of $1,015.4 billion for all its operations in 2022. 35% of the 2022 resource envelope translating to $352 million was allocated to compensation of employees, 55% which is $563.4 million to use of goods and services and the remainder of $100 million which 10% to acquisition of non-financial assets. The Commission has two Programs through which Commission activities are implemented namely Governance and Administration and National Peace and Reconciliation. Governance and Administration, which is Program 1, has five sub programs under it and received 75% of the total budget. The structures that support the programming work for the Commission are housed under Program 1 hence the substantial resource allocation. The remaining 25% of the budget was allocated to Program 2 (National Peace and Reconciliation) with four sub programs.

As of the 31st December 2022, 91% of the total budget was released and consumed.

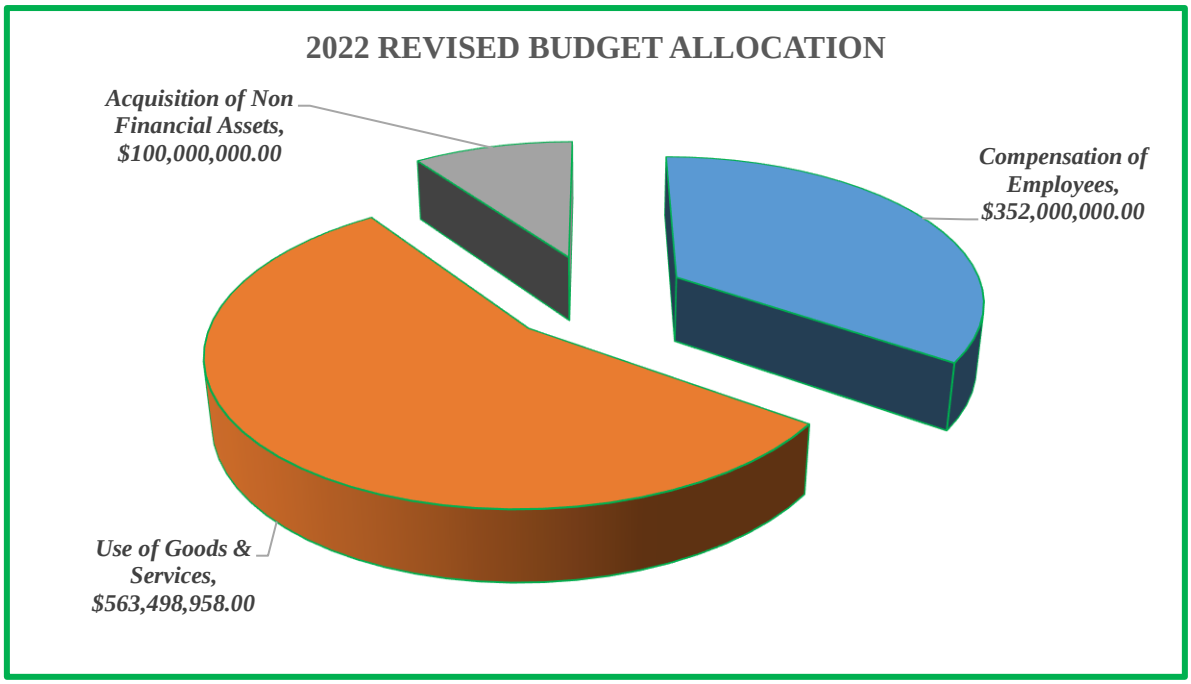


Figure 3.33: Disaggregated allocation of NPRC 2022 budget

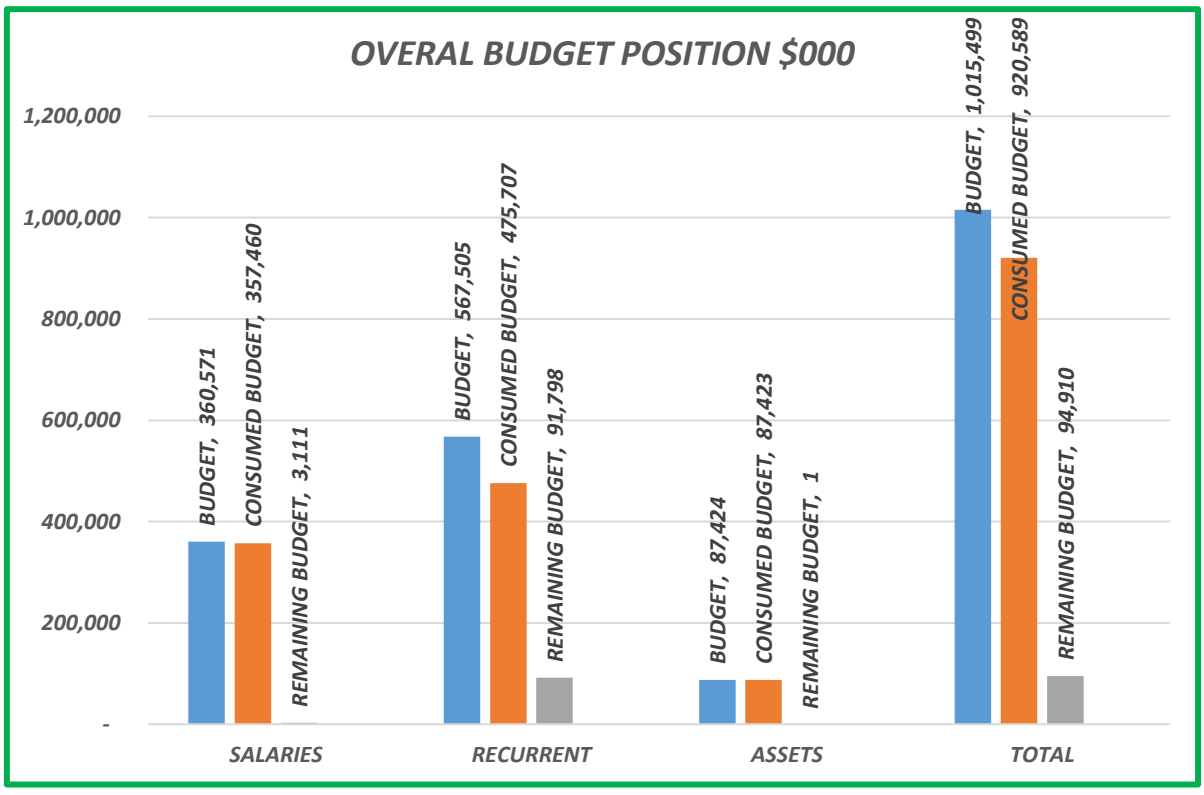


Figure 3.34 NPRC budget position as at 31 December 2022

b. Acquisition of Non-Financial Assets

The Commission was allocated a total of $100 million for procurement of non-financial assets for the period under review. As of 31st of December, the Commission had used $87.4 million for acquisition of non-financial assets and the other $12.6 million was moved through virement to other pressing areas. The resources went towards the procurement of 4 pool vehicles as well as additional furniture and ICT equipment.



Figure 3.35 Thematic Chairperson for Finance, Administration and Human Resources, Commissioner Dr Shambare presents the financial position of the Commission before Chairpersons of the Senate's Thematic Committee on Peace and Security and Parliaments Portfolio Committee on Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs

3.6.2 HUMAN RESOURCES AND ADMINISTRATION

Human Resources and Administration matters dealt with during the year are as follows:

3.6.2.1 Recruitment, Staff Turnover, Training and Induction

The Commission successfully held a staff induction programme in May 2022. The induction sessions were facilitated by internal and external facilitators. The Commission also conducted a Commissioners' retreat in May 2022 as they were reviewing their progress after completion of their first year in office. The Speaker of Parliament, Honorable J. Mudenda, graced the occasion. The Commission successfully conducted a Strategic Planning Review Workshop which was held at ZIPAM in December 2022. The Chairperson, Vice Chairperson, Commissioners and the Secretariat at management level were in attendance.



Figure 3.36: Vice Chairperson, Rev Dr C. Moyo (second from left), flanked by Commissioners (seated in front row); Commissioner Dr Chekenyere (left), Commissioner Dr Rukuni (third from left) and Commissioner Adv Gutu (right) follow proceedings during a staff induction program

As at 31 December 2022, the Commission had a total number of 92 members of staff in post against a total establishment of 105 which is inadequate for the Head Office, regional and provincial offices. The greatest challenge faced in the year is high labour turnover with eighteen staff members at different levels having left the Commission in the year under review. The Commission continued to lose its staff to other Commissions, Government Ministries, Departments and Agencies with better conditions of service. The continuous recruitment of staff to fill in vacant positions created by the inevitable labour turnover is not only inconvenient but very costly and impacted negatively on the ability of the Commission to accomplish its objectives.

3.6.2.2 Setting up of Provincial Offices

As part of the decentralization strategy as prescribed in Section 6 (3)(a) of the NPRC Act, the Commission started work to cascade down to Provinces in fulfillment of the devolution exercise offices were set up in Masvingo Province. The Commission also secured office space in the Mashonaland West Provincial Capital, Chinhoyi.

3.6.3 PROCUREMENT

3.6.3.1 Compliance Matters

The Commission's Accounting Officer:

a) Established a Procurement Management Unit in terms of Section 17 of the Public Procurement and Disposal of Public Assets (PPDPA) Act;
b) Applied for authority to conduct procurement in terms of Section 15 of the PPDPA Act and was placed in Class A which expired on 31 December 2022;
c) Submitted the 2022 Annual and Individual Procurement Plans in terms of Sections 22 and 23 of the PPDPA Act;
d) Reduced cases of non-compliance regarding document adequacy;
e) Submitted 12 of 12 monthly procurement returns for the year 2022;
f) Did not enter into any shared procurement arrangement with any other Procuring Entity. However, the Accounting Officer sourced Covid-19 requirements from NatPharm in terms of Treasury Circular number 7 of 2020.

3.6.3.2 Tender Performance

This is measured by noting the average number of quotations and bids submitted by suppliers when using Request for Quotations (RFQ) and Competitive Bidding methods respectively. The Commission's tender performance has been enhanced through the use of the website, digital media spaces and the notice board.

3.6.3.3 Major Procurements in 2022

The Commission made the following major procurements:

a) Vehicles
b) Office furniture
c) Office equipment
d) Laptops and mobile phones

3.6.4 MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION PROGRAMS

3.6.4.1 Mandate of the Unit

Section 11 of the NPRC Regulations, SI 90 of 2018 mandates the Commission to engage in publicity, communication and outreach programmes meant to inform and educate victims,

partners, stakeholders and the general public on the mandate of the Commission. The Commission facilitated the publicity of Commission programmes which received comprehensive media coverage in both the print and the electronic media. Some of the programs done to ensure coverage of NPRC work are highlighted below:

3.6.4.2 NPRC in the Newspapers


dailynews
www.dailynews.co.zw
TELLING IT LIKE IT IS ...WITHOUT FEAR, WITHOUT FAVOUR.
NPRC promoting peace before '23
... as political tensions rise ahead of crunch elections
Scandals floor Boris Johnson
Survey 2022
Gazette
OLDMUTU

Figure 3.37 Newspaper publication on NPRC

https://www.herald.co.zw/nprc-hails-peace-initiatives/

https://www.herald.co.zw/nprc-meets-parliamentarians/

https://www.herald.co.zw/nprc-denounces-poll-violence/

https://www.herald.co.zw/nprc-to-enforce-peace-pledge-ahead-of-by-elections/

https://www.newsday.co.zw/topic/national-peace-and-reconciliation-commission-nprc

https://www.newsday.co.zw/topic/together-with-the-national-peace-and-reconciliation-commission-nprc

https://dailynews.co.zw/nprc-is-finalising-zimbabwes-peace-pledge/

https://dailynews.co.zw/nprc-strives-to-temper-tensions-as-major-political-parties-welcome-the-initiative/

https://bulawayo24.com/index-id-news-sc-local-byo225804.html

https://www.manicapost.co.zw/chiadzwa-chipinge-conflicts-probed/

https://www.chronicle.co.zw/nprc-decentralises-services/

https://www.chronicle.co.zw/nprc-calls-for-political-tolerance/

3.6.4.3 Updating Digital Sites

Various NPRC digital sites played a critical role in the dissemination of information on the Commission's programmes as well as engagements with stakeholders. NPRC website, Twitter handle, Facebook page had regular posts and feedback.

3.6.4.4 ZITF Exhibition



Figure 3.38 ZANU-PF Vice President Cde K.C.D. Mohadi (second from right) visiting NPRC stand at ZITF in Bulawayo

The Commission exhibited at the Zimbabwe International Trade Fair (ZITF) whose objective was to raise public awareness on the Commission and also engage with various stakeholders at the exhibition. Visitors to the NPRC exhibition expressed their desire for the Commission to be more visible on the ground and conduct peace building programs in remote communities where conflicts often erupt without effective responses.

3.6.4.5 Commission Publicity

The Commission produced publicity materials such a fliers, T-shirts, key holders, caps and hats. The Unit also assisted to design and mount billboards together with VSGD who had collaborated with Women's Coalition of Zimbabwe. Commemorative messages on major national events (Independence, Heroes' and Defence Forces Days) as well as Commission aligned events were also generated and shared through print, broadcast and social media platforms. Radio and Television slots from national and community broadcasters were secured for the Commission's Spokesperson and Commissioners to talk about the work of the Commission and that enhanced the visibility and coverage of NPRC work.



Figure 3.39: Commissioner Dr Rukuni and Commissioner Dr Dube at Avuxeni FM in Chiredzi

Efforts were made to facilitate adequate coverage on radio, newspapers and digital sites to ensure that Zimbabweans were kept abreast with the work that the Commission was doing.

Programs that were exhaustively covered include the voter peace education campaigns, the SCORE survey, International Day of Peace commemorations, meeting of peace champions and the engagements on UNSC Resolution 1325.



Figure 3.40: Commissioner Dr Rukuni (extreme left), flanked by members of the Masvingo Provincial Peace Committee at one of the Commission's billboards mounted in Masvingo

3.6.5 RESOURCE MOBILIZATION AND PARTNERSHIPS

In 2022, the Commission appointed one of its General Managers to head the Resource Mobilization Unit with the support of two Managers and an Officer. The Resource Mobilisation Strategy developed in 2021 continued to be the guiding document for the Thematic Committee and was revised to align it to further guidance received from the Commission.

3.6.5.1 Private Sector Resource Mobilization

In recognition of the need for partnerships, the Commission sought audience with private sector partners in order to ensure an environment conducive to the conduct of business operations and therefore economic development. The Commission developed a list of possible funders disaggregated by sector. Of special note were corporates operating in areas where conflict usually occurs. These include corporates in the retail and extractive industry,

including mines. The basis for the focus on the private sector was that corporates are one of the most affected by conflict when it arises.

In view of the upcoming harmonized elections in 2023, and the possibility of conflicts that arise during such times, the Commission sought to sensitise the business sector on the need for partnership in peacekeeping. The need for peace extends to the mining sector, where the violence sometimes perpetuated in mining areas disturbs the smooth operations of mining houses. As such, mining houses were implored to partner with the Commission as well in peacebuilding.

3.6.5.2 Due Diligence in Resource Mobilization

As much as the Commission requires additional funding, due diligence needs to be exercised in the choice of funding partners in line with Section 18 of the NPRC Act. In light of this, the Commission held meetings with the Minister of Justice and Parliamentary Affairs; being the Minister responsible for the Commission; the Permanent Secretary of Foreign Affairs and International Trade and the Speaker of the Parliament of Zimbabwe. The objective of the meetings was to receive continued guidance on the donor landscape in the country. During the year partnerships were established and funding assistance received from the United Nations Development Program, UN Women and other development assistance partners. The Government of Zimbabwe remains the key funding arm of the Commission.

3.6.6 MONITORING AND EVALUATION

Monitoring and Evaluation was conducted through fieldwork. Two of the major nationwide programmes that the Commission had were the Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index survey as well as Voter Peace Education. Data was collected in all the ten provinces to establish compliance with standards, meeting of targets and assessing impact. Findings reveal that NPRC programmes were designed in line with the Strategic Plan. Participation in Commission programs was inclusive since stakeholders were drawn from various organisations and this ensured that interventions addressed the needs of citizens. The Commission’s programmes were compatible with other programmes that were being conducted by other players in the country.

All programs were gender balanced and participants were involved in all stages of program implementation. Resources were allocated according to the needs in various departments. Priority was given to the SCORE survey as the development of the index is one of the key performance indicators of the Commission in NDS 1. In terms of timeliness, some programmes were affected by the lag in budgetary support resulting in some activities being rescheduled or sometimes being overtaken by events. In order to measure impact on the programmes that NPRC is implementing, an impact assessment is scheduled to be conducted in 2023. This assessment will serve as the baseline in terms of planning and designing other programmes and meeting the needs of stakeholders. The sustainability of the work carried out by the NPRC can be ensured through strengthening infrastructures for peace that have potential to live beyond the life of the Commission.

4 STRATEGIES FOR GENDER MAINSTREAMING

Section 9 of the NPRC Act calls for the mainstreaming of gender imperatives into every aspect of the Commission's work and further mandates the Commission to ensure gender equity in its structure, its secretariat and any other committees that may be set up. This section details measures that were put in place to engender Commission programmes and activities.



Figure 3.41: Catching them young- Drum majorettes join NPRC in the commemoration of the International Day of Peace in the City of Gweru, Midlands Province

4.1 Gender Mainstreaming within the Commission

To facilitate structured and coordinated mainstreaming of gender, all Commission Thematic Departments developed gender mainstreaming annual work plans. The work plans engrained 2022 gender mainstreaming activities to be pursued by each Department. The work plans also ensured accountability on gender mainstreaming and implementation of the Gender and Inclusion Policy. Guidance on gender mainstreaming was also provided to gender-focal persons through gender desk officers, and through gender-focal persons review meetings that were conducted during the year. The review meetings rallied momentum on the need to sustain

the implementation of gender-responsive peacebuilding initiatives in the Commission whilst strengthening gender mainstreaming and victim support capacity of gender focal persons.

4.2 Mainstreaming Gender Imperatives Across the Commission Programmes

The following section highlights the gender dimensions in the implementation of Commission programmes in 2022:

4.2.1 Conflict Prevention, Management, Resolution and Transformation

i) Gender Mainstreaming in By-Elections Observation and Voter Peace Education

The Conflict Prevention, Management, Resolution and Transformation programmes revolved around by-elections observation as well as peace education campaigns. In recognition of the differential impact of conflict and violence on different groups of people, deliberate efforts were made to ensure the participation of women, youth and other vulnerable groups in the peace education campaigns. The peace education campaign programme reached a total of 24911 people comprising 11366 males and 13545 females. The terms of reference for the by-elections observation teams also focused on establishing factors that hinder and/or propel women and other vulnerable groups' participation in electoral processes. The by-elections observation findings concurred with the observations made during voter peace education campaigns as follows:

a) In some instances, women are subjected to violence by peers, family members or friends in an attempt to discourage them from participating in politics;

b) Communities were concerned about violence in electoral processes noting that they hinder women's participation as voters and candidates;

c) Community members, particularly women were concerned that organizational programmes and election processes disturb the day-to-day livelihood operations, particularly for women in the informal sector;

d) There was a general low level of youth participation in voter peace education campaigns while on contrary, they were regarded as the main perpetrators of political violence in communities;

e) Persons with disabilities (PWD) were not effectively reached during the peace education programmes;

f) Most women reported suffering psychological trauma from past violent electoral processes.

ii) Strategies to Strengthen Gender Mainstreaming in Conflict Prevention

From the by-election's observations and voter peace education campaigns, the following are key recommendations for strengthening gender-responsive conflict prevention and responding to conflict-related gender-based violence during electoral periods:

a) Accelerate and sustain gender-inclusive voter peace education campaigns to transform communities from a culture of violence in electoral processes;
b) Apply a multi-sectoral and collaborative approach in preventing and responding to gender-based violence during electoral periods to strengthen women's participation in electoral processes;
c) Government to enforce existing electoral laws to prevent, punish and eradicate electoral violence against women;
d) Treasury and development partners to strengthen resource mobilisation for the full implementation of mechanisms for the prevention of CRGBV and protection measures for survivors of CRGBV, particularly violence against women during elections;
e) Accelerate the operationalisation of the National Conflict Early Warning, Early Response System to facilitate real-time response to CRGBV during the 2023 Harmonised Elections;
f) Develop a robust system for documentation and monitoring of electoral CRGBV;
g) Conduct nationwide gender inclusive engagements on the prevention of conflict-related GBV.

4.2.2 Gender Sensitive Conflict Resolution and Mediation Training

To strengthen skills in gender mainstreaming, conflict analysis, mediation and conflict resolution, two sessions of Gender-Sensitive Conflict Management, Prevention and Resolution virtual trainings for women in Peace Committees were conducted. The pieces of training provided knowledge and expertise on gender-sensitive conflict analysis, mediation and conflict resolution, increased engagement of women in peacebuilding and advanced the role of women in promoting peace at the community level as well as providing an opportunity for women mediators to share experiences.

Table 4.1: Schedule of Trainings on Gender Sensitive Conflict Resolution

	Dates	Males	Females	Total
1st Group	10-11 October 2022	3	17	20
2nd Group	13-14 October 2022	2	18	20
Total		**5**	**35**	**40**

4.2.3 Research and Knowledge Management

The NPRC 2022 research was geared towards the establishment of the Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index for Zimbabwe. As part of mainstreaming gender in SCORE research, an enquiry was made on the gendered dimensions of social cohesion and reconciliation in the country. The mainstreaming of gender in the SCORE research will help to consolidate and address gender dimensions of conflicts for the achievement of equitable national social cohesion.

4.2.4 Complaints Handling and Investigations

Applying victim-centred and gender-sensitive lenses is critical during Complaints Handling and Investigations. Information on all cases handled during complaints handling and investigations was disaggregated by sex, a variable which is important in analysing the gender dimensions of cases investigated by the Commission. Follow-up victim support was provided to all victims that the Commission interacted with during the investigations. A gender focal person to coordinate gender mainstreaming activities related to complaints handling and investigations. The deployment of investigators comprised of both males and females.

4.2.5 Healing, Reconciliation and Rehabilitation

To pursue healing, reconciliation and rehabilitation, the Commission focused its activities on community healing and anti-drug and substance abuse awareness programmes. The anti-drug and substance abuse awareness programme revealed the following gender issues of concern:

a) Most girls are being gang raped, sexually abused and exposed to sexually transmitted infections (STIs) after taking drugs;
b) Women are experiencing physical abuse and trauma from spouses that are abusing drugs and there are looming conflicts as women seek alternative sources of income through prostitution when spouses who are drug addicts cannot provide for the family.

As part of healing, victim support in the form of group and individual counselling was provided during all the community healing sessions. To create safe spaces and enable women to effectively participate in the healing processes, dedicated sessions for women were also conducted. Furthermore, the community healing programmes used approaches that women and marginalized groups were comfortable and familiar with such as facilitation through local churches and local community groups. This enabled more women, youth and other marginalized groups to participate in healing programmes thus enabling them to contribute to peace-building and community social cohesion.

4.3 Gender Mainstreaming in the Structure of the Commission

Section 9 of the NPRC Act mandates the Commission to ensure gender equity in all its structures. The table below reveals the current composition of staff as of December 2022. Women continue to dominate the lower-level positions of Managers, Officers and below while men dominate the high-level positions of General Managers.

Table 4.2 Gender Composition of Staff and Commissioners

Position	Males	Females	In Post	% Female Representation
Commissioners	5	4	9	44
Executive Secretary	0	1	1	100
General Managers	4	2	6	33
Manager	4	9	13	69
Officer and Below	27	36	73	49
TOTAL	**40**	**52**	**92**	**57**

4.4 Accelerating Gender Mainstreaming in the Commission

In order to accelerate gender mainstreaming in the Commission, there is need to:

a) Address gender imbalances in employment categories in which either gender is under-represented. During the recruitment process for a post in a category in which there is a gender imbalance, the under-represented sex should be given priority;
b) Build strategic alliances and create coalitions of local and national women's rights organisations, peace advocates and experts for information sharing, strategy

development and implementation of victim-centred and gender-inclusive peacebuilding interventions;

c) Strengthen the capacity of Commissioners and staff on gender analysis and the design and implementation of gender-inclusive interventions. All employees should undergo routine training and capacity building on gender mainstreaming;
d) Capacitate all peace committee members on gender-sensitive peacebuilding instead of undertaking a selective approach which is currently used due to the unavailability of resources;
e) Create collaborative relationships with the media, and capacitate them to accurately report on gender and inclusion issues concerning the mandate of the Commission;
f) Increase budgetary allocation to the NPRC, mobilise resources to supplement treasury allocations, and strengthen implementation of gender-responsive budgeting at national and NPRC institutional levels for the full and effective implementation of gender mainstreaming initiatives.

5.0 LESSONS LEARNT AND CHALLENGES

5.1 Lessons Learnt from NPRC Programs Conducted in 2022

Table 5.1 Lessons Learnt from NPRC Programs in 2022

Area	Lessons Learnt
ICT, Media and Communication	a) Implementation of activities can be enhanced, through the use of communication and visibility tools, technology, new approaches, and creativity; b) Exhibitions allow the Commission to interface with the public and give citizens a place to lodge their grievances and complaints.
Finance	a) As the Commission is decentralizing to the Regions, a specific sub-program should be created to buttress those efforts.
Conflict Prevention and Non-Recurrence	a) Effective conflict early warning and early response programmes lead to the ability to effectively monitor the changing conflict dynamics on multiple different levels.
Monitoring and Evaluation	a) Capturing and using lessons derived from evaluations can provide a range of benefits within a programme or project.
Complaints Handling and Investigations	a) The public's trust in the Commission can be damaged if investigations are not completed in a timely and robust manner, increasing the likelihood of deterioration in the state of affairs being investigated; b) Some people, mainly those at grassroot levels are not aware of the complaints handling and reporting mechanisms in place to assist victims.
Research and Knowledge Management	a) More funding should be channelled towards community-based research in order to produce authentic data; b) The Commission needs to invest in a Peace-Conflict Impact Assessment model owing to the increase in the number of development related conflicts

Healing, Reconciliation and Rehabilitation	a) Partnerships and collaboration with the stakeholders allow for the Commission to reach a wider scope of Communities; b) School children are the most affected population by drugs and substance abuse in Zimbabwe, as such, the highest impact in programming for the prevention of the social ill is in schools; c) Communities require assistance in accepting former prison inmates back into the society upon release from prison.
Victim Support, Gender and Diversity	a) Capacity building programmes on the design and implementation of gender inclusive and victim-centred interventions will strengthen the Commission's approach to victim support, gender and diversity issues; b) Conflict related GBV during electoral processes as well as in areas affected by strife and emergencies is prevalent thus requiring accelerated awareness campaigns on ending all forms of violence against women and child marriages.
Resource Mobilization and Partnerships	a) The competition for scarce resources needs the Commission to implement a robust fundraising model; b) Sustainable partnerships should be forged at all levels, targeting critical stakeholders in the peacebuilding ecosystem.

5.2 Challenges Experienced in 2022

The overall challenges that impacted negatively on the Commission include:

a) Delays in receiving financial resources for implementation of Commission programs;
b) Inflationary pressures which result in under-resourcing for programs as rising prices of goods and services reduce the quantity and quality of material purchased;
c) High staff turnover has resulted in some departments operating with lean staff;
d) Procurement delays as a result of the centralised Enterprise Resource Planning system;
e) Polarisation which is evidenced by a lot of negative responses on the Commission's digital media sites; and in the field manifesting in the hesitancy by political actors to coalesce on the common goal of building peace.

6.0 RECOMMENDATIONS FOR THE PROMOTION OF PEACE

6.1 Introduction

The NPRC is required in terms of Section 252 (j) of the Constitution of Zimbabwe to recommend legislation to ensure that persons affected by conflicts, pandemics or other circumstances are assisted. Further, the NPRC Act provides that legislative, administrative or other practical reforms to prevent, manage or resolve conflicts be included in the Commission's Annual Report. The recommendations are drawn from the programs conducted by the Commission in pursuit of its constitutional functions. Below are the proposed legislative, policy and administrative recommendations;

6.2 Legal, Policy and Administrative Recommendations

6.2.1 Human and Wildlife Conflicts

The Commission received several complaints of human and wildlife conflicts, particularly areas located within the proximity of Game Parks and Wild Life Sanctuaries. The interaction between humans and wildlife has led to the loss of human life and wildlife, severe injuries to humans leading to disabilities, destruction to property and loss of livelihood as agricultural fields and gardens have been destroyed by wildlife. Zimbabwe is a party to several international environmental Conventions which ensure the protection of wildlife including elephants. Wildlife conservation is governed by the Environmental Management Act [Chapter 20.27], the Environmental Land Forest Produce Act [Chapter 19:04], the Forest Act [Chapter [19:05] and the National Environmental Policy and Strategies of 2009.

The protection of wildlife has resulted in the banning of practices detrimental to animals and the environment. Prohibition of culling of animals such as elephants to control animal population has led to a drastic increase in the wildlife population. Communities residing in the proximity of Game Parks expressed that laws protecting animals favour the needs of animals more than their own. The increase in animal population burdens the environment, especially water sources. Although such areas are designated as tourist areas, local communities do not benefit but bear the brunt of the negative impacts emanating from co-existing with wildlife. The Commission recommends;

Legal Recommendations

a) It is necessary for the law to provide for environmentally friendly mechanisms to control animal populations considering the availability of resources, the rights of communities residing within those areas to access natural resources.
b) It is proposed that the Parks and Wildlife Act supports local communities to manage local natural resources in their areas whilst at the same time benefiting financially from their management and conservation through community-based natural resources management programmes such as CAMPFIRE.

Policy Recommendations

a) Authorities may need to consider reinforced implementation of the National Environmental Policy and Strategies of 2009 which established programmes such as the CAMPFIRE to ensure that local communities manage local natural resources in their areas and benefit financially. The principles of accountability, transparency and access to information embedded in the Policy also need to be enforced;
b) Consideration should be made for a compensation policy and compensation fund that covers injury, death, and loss of property including livestock and crops to be formulated. At present communities that have lost their loved ones, property, or crops, or have been injured by wildlife have no redress and remain uncompensated.

Administrative Recommendations

a) The CAMPFIRE program is managed by a committee established through elections within the community. The proceeds of CAMPFIRE are managed by the Rural District Councils and this results in delays in local communities receiving their share of benefits. It is recommended that decision-making powers in CAMPFIRE programs be devolved to the Committees as they represent the community;

6.2.2 Traditional Leadership Appointment Disputes

The appointment of traditional leaders in some areas has often been contentious delaying the appointment of chiefs, headmen or village heads. Delays in appointment may leave affected communities without substantive leadership, resulting in uncertainty which may ignite conflicts. The Commission while conducting its investigations noted that communities raised concerns about the conflicts surrounding the appointment of traditional leaders. In some cases,

conflicts arose in respect of jurisdictional demarcation or boundaries of Chiefs. The prolonged delay in peacefully resolving the conflict led to tensions between the Chiefs and their communities. The Commission proposes the following recommendations;

Legal Recommendations

a) The jurisdictional boundaries of Chiefs are governed by Statutory Instruments S.I 548 of 1980 and S.I 115 of 1989. These laws provide for different demarcations of boundaries which affects the jurisdictional areas of Chiefs leading to a long-standing conflict between chiefs and the communities they preside over. It is recommended that the laws relating to the delimitation of boundaries that the Chiefs have jurisdiction over, be harmonised to settle longstanding jurisdictional disputes.
b) It is recommended that Section 39 of the Traditional Leaders Act be amended to incorporate Section 286 (1) of the Constitution which empowers the Chief's Council to facilitate the settlement of disputes between Chiefs.

Policy Recommendations

a) Section 286 (1) (f) of the Constitution empowers the Chief's Council to facilitate the settlement of disputes between and concerning traditional leaders. It is recommended that the Chief's Council sets up dispute resolution structure to assist in the settlement of disputes between Chiefs.

6.2.3 Political Parties Conflicts

The by-elections conducted in the country have led to emerging conflicts between political parties, before, during and post-elections. In some cases, political conflicts have led to violence, injury of people and destruction of property. The findings of the Commission while conducting investigations are that the youth are perceived as malleable and easy to use as tools to commit violence by some political parties. Alcohol abuse and unemployment render the youth vulnerable to influence by some political leaders. Investigations also uncovered the gendered nature of political violence against women and girls. It is recommended that;

Policy Recommendations

a) Measures to enforce the Electoral Code of Conduct for Political Parties, Candidates and Other Stakeholders to be put in place as well as consequences of not adhering to it spelt out;

b) The signing of peace pledge to be regulated for political parties to commit to a peaceful electoral process.

6.3 General Recommendations

In light of operational challenges and programs carried out by the Commission in 2022, the following additional recommendations are made;

6.2.1 To address the limited visibility of the NPRC, it is recommended that public media institutions have concessionary rates for the publication of adverts and infomercials that are in the public interest.

6.2.2 To achieve the objectives of the NDS1 it is recommended that peace and tolerance be highlighted by public officials at all public events.

6.2.3 A halfway house helps individuals transition from prison to reintegration into society. It is recommended that halfway homes to assist in the reintegration of former prison inmates back into community be established at national, regional and community levels.

7.0 CONCLUSION

The year 2022 saw the Commission prioritizing the decentralization and devolution agenda, with additional provincial offices being set up in Masvingo whilst efforts are being made to have offices in Matabeleland South, Matabeleland North, Mashonaland East, Mashonaland West and Harare. Working together with different stakeholders and partners, the Commission conducted valuable community engagements on peacebuilding and sustaining peace through innovative, inclusive and consultative processes. The Commission attended to complaints that were received, carried out a Social Cohesion and Reconciliation Index survey, expanded the number of peace infrastructures that it works with, conducted voter peace education campaigns, observed the by-elections in March 2022, conducted consultations on the development of the Women and Youth in Peace and Security National Action Plans, finalised the customisation of the CEWER System, commemorated key events such as the International Day of Peace and 16 Days of Activism Against Gender Based Violence and conducted programs on community healing and addressing substance abuse and the menace of suicides; among other programs.

The Commission's infrastructures for peace have been the gateway through which programs and activities are coordinated at provincial levels. Notable programs such as SCORE, peace education, international commemorations and investigations were facilitated through these infrastructures, something that provides guarantees of sustainable platforms and networks for peacebuilding. The Commission appreciates the goodwill of these dedicated volunteers who selflessly contributed to the implementation of these programs and that of Zimbabweans across the divide who continue to work closely with each other to deliver a peaceful and united country. Also appreciated are the many stakeholders of the Commission; the Government of Zimbabwe, Parliament of Zimbabwe, development partners, civil society actors, church and other faith-based institutions, the security sector, political institutions, academia, traditional leaders, corporates and many others, without whose cooperation the results of NPRC's work would have been miniscule. We wish Zimbabweans a peaceful 2023.

Lunyalalo lunotanga nami, lunyalalo lunotanga nawi, lunyalalo lunotanga nasu tose;

Mulalo uthoma nga nne, mulalo uthoma nga vhone, mulalo uthoma ngarine rothe;

Kagiso e simolola ka nna; kagiso e simolola ka wena; kagiso e simolola ka rona rotlhe;

Runyararo runoquaya neni; runyararo runoquaya newe; runyararo runoquaya nesu teshe;

Uxolo luqala nam; uxolo luqala nawe; uxolo luqala nathi sonke;

Mtendere uyambe kukhala ndiine; mtendere uyambe kukhala ndi iwe; mtendere uyenela kuhkala watonse iwe ndi ine;

Runyararo rumbawambira naiwe; runyararo rumbawambira naiwepo, runyararo rumbawambira naife pano;

Kunyalala kotanga nami; kunyalala kotanga nawe; kunyalala kotanga naswi tose;

Kurhula kusungula ni mina; kurhula kusungula hi wena; kurhula kusungula hi hina hi kwerhu;

Khotso ea qala le ´na; khotso ea qala le uena; Khotso ea qala le rona kaofela;

Luumuno lutalika andime; luumuno lutalika anduwe; luumuno lutalika andiswe toonse;

Peace begins with me, peace begins with you; peace begins with all of us;

Ukuthula kuqala ngami, Ukuthula kuqala ngawe, Ukuthula kuqala ngathi sonke;

Runyararo runotanga neni; runyararo runotanga newe; runyararo runotanga nesu tose;

Nko kua ti ka mi; nko kua tja ka mi; nko kua tjam ie ka tja

Ref: NPRC 2/25/21

REPORT OF THE AUDITOR-GENERAL

TO

THE EXECUTIVE SECRETARY

TO THE NATIONAL PEACE AND RECONCILIATION COMMISSION

IN RESPECT OF
VOTE 29.- APPROPRIATION ACCOUNT

FOR THE YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 2021

Report on the Audit of the Appropriation Account

Opinion

I have audited the financial statements of the National Peace and Reconciliation Commission for the year ended December 31, 2021. These financial statements comprise the Appropriation Account, Finance and Revenue Statements and other supporting returns.

In my opinion, the financial statements fairly present the state of affairs of the National Peace and Reconciliation Commission as at December 31, 2021 in accordance with Generally Accepted Accounting Practice (GAAP).

Basis for Opinion

I conducted my audit in accordance with International Standards of Supreme Audit Institutions (ISSAls). My responsibilities under those standards are further described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements section of my report. I am independent of the National Peace and Reconciliation Commission in accordance with the ethical requirements that are relevant to my audit of the financial statements, and I have fulfilled my other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements. I believe that the audit evidence I have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for my opinion.

Key Audit Matters

Key Audit Matters are those matters that, in my professional judgement, were of most significance in my audit of the financial statements of the current period. During the year under review no other Key Audit Matters were addressed in the context of my audit of the financial statements as a whole.

Information Other than the Financial Statements and Auditor's Report Thereon

Management is responsible for the Other Information. The Other Information comprises information in the National Peace and Reconciliation Commission annual report but does not include the Financial Statements and my auditor's report thereon.

My opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other Information and I do not express any form of assurance conclusion thereon.

In connection with my audit of the financial statements, my responsibility is to read the Other Information and, in doing so, consider whether the Other Information is materially inconsistent with the Financial Statements or my knowledge obtained in the audit or otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If, based on the work I have performed, I conclude that there is a material misstatement of the Other Information, I am required to report that fact. I have nothing to report in this regard.

Responsibilities of Management and Those Charged with Governance for the Financial Statements

Management is responsible for the preparation of these financial statements in a manner required by the Public Finance Management Act [Chapter 22:19], Treasury Instructions and Circular on preparation and submission of financial statements.

These responsibilities include designing, implementing and maintaining internal control relevant to the preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error; selecting and applying appropriate accounting policies; and making accounting estimates that are reasonable in the circumstances.

Those charged with governance are responsible for overseeing the National Peace and Reconciliation Commission financial reporting process.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements

The objectives of my audit are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatements, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes my opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but it's not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISSAls will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

As part of an audit in accordance with ISSAls, I exercise professional judgement and maintain professional skepticism throughout the planning and performance of the audit. I also:

- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for my opinion. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than for one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control.

- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the entity's internal control.

- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates and related disclosures made by management.

- Evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the financial statements, including the disclosures, and whether the financial statements represent the underlying transactions and events in a manner that achieves fair presentation.

I communicate with management regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that I identify during my audit.

I also provide management with a statement that I have complied with relevant ethical requirements regarding independence, and to communicate with them all relationships and other matters that may reasonably be thought to bear on my independence, and where applicable, related safeguards.

From the matters communicated with management, I determine those matters that were of most significance in the audit of the financial statements of the current period and are therefore the key audit matters. I describe these matters in my auditor's report unless law or regulation precludes public disclosure about the matter or when, in extremely rare circumstances, I determine that a matter should not be communicated in my report because the adverse consequences of doing so would reasonably be expected to outweigh the public interest benefits of such communication.

Report on Other Legal and Regulatory Requirements

In my opinion, the financial statements have, in all material respects, been properly prepared in compliance with the disclosure requirements of the Public Finance Management Act [Chapter 22:19] and other relevant Statutory Instruments.

June 2 2022

Mchiri

M. CHIRI

VOTE 29.- NATIONAL PEACE AND RECONCILIATION COMMISSION

APPROPRIATION ACCOUNT

FOR THE YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 2021

Expenditure Head	*Original Budget Estimates 2021*	*Unallocated Reserves Transfers*	*Total / Revised Budget*	*Actual Expenditure as at December 31, 2021*	*More than Estimated*	*Less than Estimated*	*Explanation for main variations*
PROGRAMME 1. GOVERNANCE AND ADMINISTRATION							
EXPENSES							
Compensation of employees.....	16 692 000	34 296 695	50 988 695	52 568 728	1 580 033	—	The excess was due to salary reviews for officers in 2021 that had not been anticipated.
Use of goods and services.....	28 779 000	34 600 000	63 379 000	71 772 449	8 393 449	—	The excess was due to general increases in the prices of goods and services.
Acquisition of fixed capital assets.....	37 960 000	—	37 960 000	37 675 190	—	284 810	
	$83 431 000	$68 896 695	$152 327 695	$162 016 367	$9 973 482	$ 284 810	
PROGRAMME 2. NATIONAL PEACE AND RECONCILIATION							
EXPENSES							
Compensation of employees.....	4 308 000	7 903 269	12 211 269	11 761 916	—	449 353	
Use of goods and services.....	24 221 000	—	24 221 000	14 787 788	—	9 433 212	The saving was due to non release of funding by Treasury as a result of lack of liquidity.
Acquisition of fixed capital assets.....	21 040 000	—	21 040 000	20 699 725	—	340 275	
	$49 569 000	$7 903 269	$57 472 269	$47 249 429	—	$10 222 840	
Total:	**$133 000 000**	**$76 799 964**	**$209 799 964**	$209 265 796	**$9 973 482**	**$10 507 650**	
Net Underspending.....					$534 168		

05 / 31 / 2022
Month / Day / Year

S. TONGAYI,
Acting Executive Secretary to the National Peace and Reconciliation Commission.